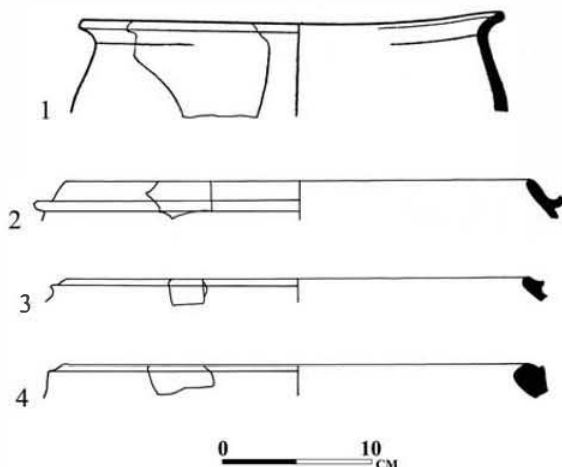




66. Pottery from Wadi Salman (2): 1-3. CPs A-B, dk gr, Ir I; 4. CP D, dk gr, Ir II.

of installations cut into rocky surfaces was discovered 12● m east of the site.

Pottery: Iron I-II – 6●%; Byzantine – 4●%.

Stone: eight rock-cut installations and a small quarry (see Eitam 2005: 68●, 682-683).

Additional surveys: none.



Site 22: 19-19/59/1

BARD ALEH (Berdeleh in the PEF map)

Israel grid: 1954/1994

UTM grid: 7333/5863

Elevation: 6● m b.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient and on map

Site type: Arab village

Area: 100 dunams at present, 5 dunams ancient nucleus (10 ha, 5000 sq. m respectively)

Topography: spurs in valley fringes

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: about 100

Nearest water sources: 'Ein Bardaleh (168a) and 'Ein el-'Iraq (168b), at the site

Nearest road: Beit She'an-Jericho (B10), 1 km distant

Visits: Jan. 1988, Nov. 1993; 70 sherds

This is a medium-sized Arab village in the southern fringes of the Beit She'an Valley. The village is situated at the juncture of the spurs sloping from Kh. Jabaris and embedded in the floodplain. 1.5 km to the west is the deep basin of Wadi Ha'shneh, leading into the Beit She'an Valley.

The ancient tell-like core of the village is fairly small. Included in it is the Sheikh Muhamad Tomb and several partially demolished houses, presumably 19th century. In and outside the village are scattered many rock-cut installations; among them winepresses, basins and cup marks. An oil press containing a rock-cut lower basin with a crushing stone next to it was found on the spur west of the village.

The British Survey members describe it thus: "Berdeleh (P m), though ruined, is inhabited in spring by the peasants from the hill villages, who descend to find pasture and to cultivate melons and other vegetables round the springs." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 227).

According to Vilnay (1968: 89) "An Arab village...its inhabitants are Moslem. The origin of its name is not known. It has two springs: 'Ein Bardaleh and 'Ein el-'Iraq. The village is situated on the bank of a stream that begins at the slope of Mount Bezeq and reaches to Nahal Bezeq."

According to Ilan (1973: 344-345) "The village was built on an ancient site... which is called by the inhabitants 'Qasr Bardawil'... In the village there are quarried caves and the inhabitants having a tradition about a king, called Bardawil, who lived here."



67. Aerial view of Bardaleh, view to the north-west, 2013 (A. Solomon).

In July 1972 a salvage excavation took place at the village under the supervision of Tiasir Hamarsha (*HA* 44: 11). The remains of two pools, connected by pipes, dated to the EM period were found, possibly the remains of a large bathhouse. It was built upon the western part of a Byz church, which had a mosaic floor with stylised crosses within a round frame and stylised flowers.

Pottery: Late Roman – 10%; Byzantine – 15%; Early Moslem – 15%; Middle Ages – 30%; Ottoman and modern – 30%.

Identification: see Chapter 2.

Additional surveys: Tzori (1962: site 52) also mentions a sheikh's tomb, southwest of the village, which was called after Khader el-Akhdar.

Additional Bibliography: Yeivin 1973: XIX.



Site 23: 19-19/99/1

‘EIN ED-DEIR

Israel grid: 1993/1995

UTM grid: 7372/5865

Elevation: 196 m b.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: tell

Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)

Topography: plain

Rock type: Dead Sea Group; silt

Soil type: silt

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: vineyard and vegetables

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: ‘Ein ed-Deir
(179a), 300 m distant

Nearest road: Beit She’an–Jericho
(B10), 2 km distant

Visits: 1991, Sep. 2001; 89 sherds

This medium-sized site, amidst the agricultural cultivated area of Beidha-Meḥola, is about 2.5 km north of Meḥola.

The site is 300 m north of ‘Ein el-Deir, on which a pumping station has been installed. The spring emerges in the upper part of a channel flowing eastward. The channel has dug into the soil and its present depth is 3–4 m. North of it rises the low tell, whose outlines are almost totally concealed by modern cultivation. In our previous visit there were remains of a few walls: these have now totally disappeared, and the building stones have been gathered in piles.

Abel (1913: 222), visited the place in 1910, and mentions a square pool that receives the spring's water. He identified the remains on the tell as those of a monastery.

In this site was a medium-sized IA settlement. The sherds found here are very similar to those from Tell el-Ḥamah and Tell Muḥaz (1).

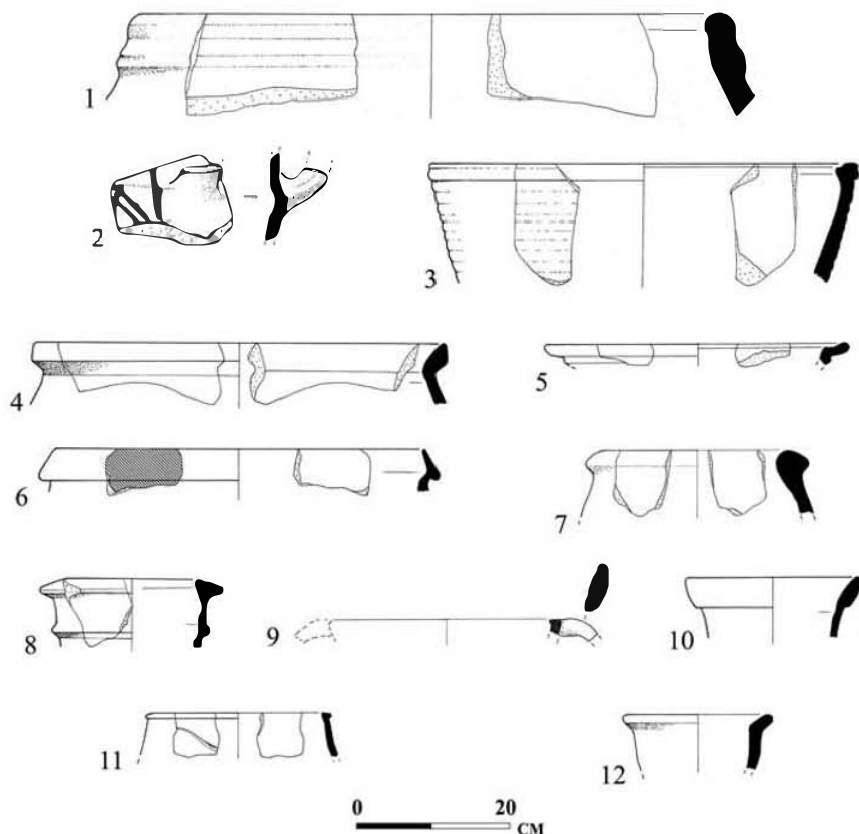
The place appears in the map as a small tell with elevation point mark -196. From Gophna and Porath's description (1972: site 45), it appears that it is possible that they did not find the site. Their description is: "A site marked in the map as a ruin without name, on a low hilltop. There are no remains of structures. A few pottery finds from the Byzantine and Medieval periods."

Pottery: Middle Bronze II – 15%; Late Bronze – 10%; Iron I – 30%; Iron II – 40%; Hellenistic – 5%.

Flint: 6 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: Mittmann 1970: site 345; Gophna and Porath 1972: site 45.

Additional Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 11.



68. Pottery from 'Ein ed-Deir: 1. Large krater, brn, Ir I; 2. Jar, rd dec on handle, LB; 3. Bowl, buff, Ir II; 4. CP A, Ir I; 5. Bowl, pk, LB; 6. CP/krater, dk brn, Ir I; 7-8. Jars, dk gr, Ir II; 9. Jug, brn, Ir I; 10. Jar, buff, Hel; 11-12. Jar and jug, gr, LB/Ir I.

Site 23 (1): 19-20/90/3

BEZEQ CANAL

Israel grid: 1993/2002

UTM grid: 7372/5872

Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: unknown

Area: unknown

Topography: plain

Rock type: Dead Sea Group; silt

Soil type: silt

Soil quality: 7

Nearest water source: 'Ein Abu-'Afif
(179b), 400 m distantNearest road: Beit She'an-Jericho
(B10), 2.3 km distant

A multi-stratum Chalcolithic site 1 km north-east of Shamsiyeh and 3 km north of Meḥola.

The site was described by Sadeh and Gophna (1991) after it was discovered in the 1960's when a water channel was being constructed. Remains of mud-brick walls of dwellings and pits were observed in the sections 50 cm below the alluvium. Pottery from all stages of the Chalcolithic continuum was collected.

This is typical of the cluster of sites from this period in the southern Jordan valley (see Bar 2014a: chapter 5 for additional data).

The site was not found by later surveys, and has probably been destroyed by the extensive agricultural works in the area.

Pottery: Chalcolithic.**Additional Bibliography:** Bar 2014a: site 6.

Site 23 (2): 19-20/90/4

KHIRBET SHEIKH HAMID AL-FATUR

Israel grid: 1991/2000

UTM grid: 7370/5870

Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient and on map

Site type: structure

Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)

Topography: plain

Rock type: Dead Sea Group; silt

Soil type: silt

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: date palm grove

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: 'Ein Abu-'Afif
(179b), 100 m distantNearest road: Beit She'an-Jericho
(B10), 2 km distant

Remains of a Sheikh's tomb – Sheikh Hamid al-Fatur, on a small elevation in the cultivated plains 3 km north of Meḥola.

The site was described by de Contenson (1964: 40), who collected Byz pottery.

Mittmamm (1970: site 346), who visited here, writes: "About 0.5 km north of Tell ed-Dēr lies a round, small tell (20-25 m in diameter, height about 2 m) Ḥirbet el-Fātūr, also known as Ḥirbet eš-šeḥ Ḥāmid. The top is covered with stones and remains of a foundation of a modern building, which was built out of the older basalt and limestone cuboids. Below these remains is a fragment of a round pillar with spiral decoration. Because of the large amount of weeds it was not possible to find much pottery. This pottery can be dated into a general Byzantine period and Umayyad and Mamluk periods. Approximately 100 m south of the site lies a spring, 'Ein el-Fātūr."

Gophna and Porath (1972: site 39) mentioned a Sheikh's tomb built over the remains of a larger Byz structure, with Byz and MA pottery. Kohn-Tavor (2010: site 106) also collected EM pottery.

Pottery (summary of the different surveys): Byzantine; Early Moslem; Middle Ages.

Additional surveys: de-Contenson (1964: 40); Gophna and Porath 1972: site 39; Kohn-Tavor 2010: site 106.

Additional Bibliography: Abel 1913: 220-222.



Site 24: 19-19/99/2

'EIN BULEIBIL

Israel grid: 1999/1996

UTM grid: 7379/5867

Elevation: 220 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: large

Area: 30 dunams (3 ha)

Topography: plain

Rock type: Dead Sea Group; silt

Soil type: silt

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops and a date-palm grove

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: 'Ein Buleibil (163), at the site

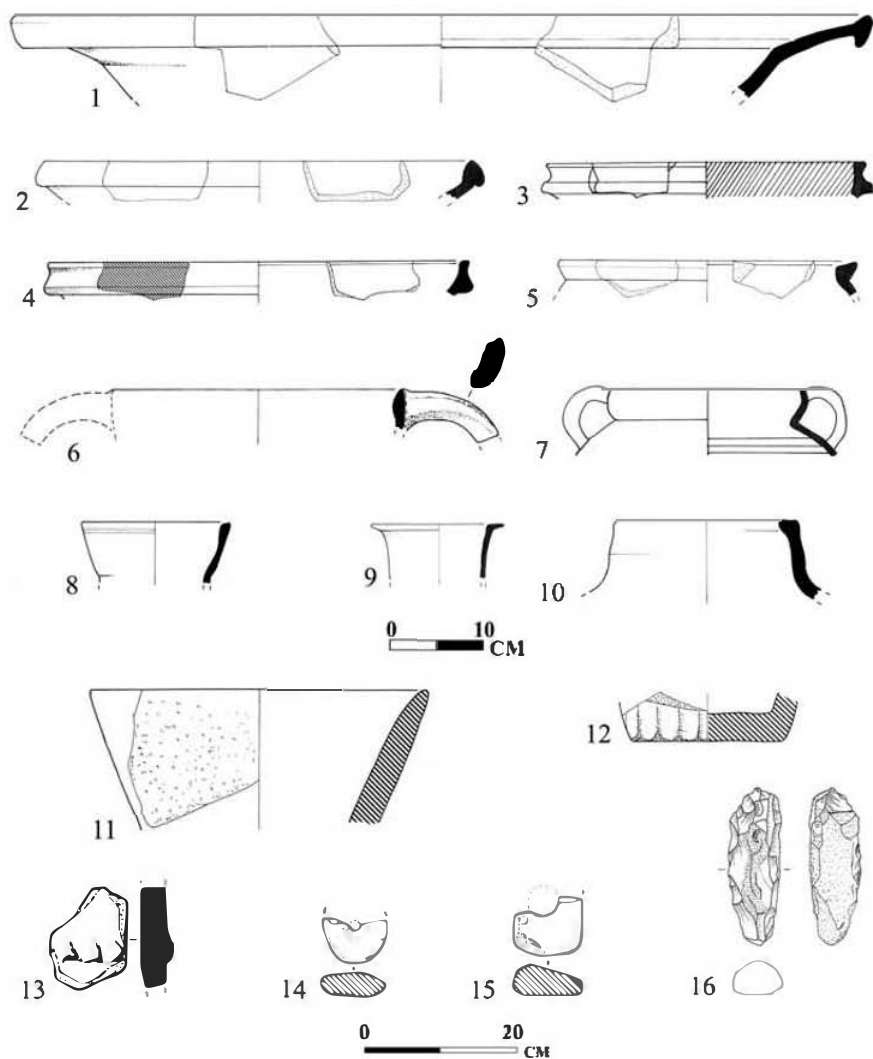
Nearest road: Shechem–Abu Sus (B8), 1.5 km distant

Visit: Sep. 1991; 120 sherds

A large site in a hillocky plain, in the large cultivated area between Meḥola and Tirat Zvi. The site is close to two springs named 'Ein Buleibil. Most of the site

is presently in a palm grove, situated about 1 km south of Tell el-Ridhghah and 3 km north of Melhola.

The site is bounded in the east by eastern 'Ein Buleibil and in the north by a deep water channel between it and Tell el-Ridhghah. Close to the eastern spring there is a small elevation (25×20 m), below which is an ancient structure. Scattered wall lines and building stones protrude throughout this part of



69. Finds from 'Ein Buleibil, no. 1-10 – LR; no. 11-16 – Chal: 1. Large bowl, lt brn; 2-4. Bowls, lt brn with rd slip; 5. Bowl, brn; 6. Jar, brn; 7. CP, lt brn; 8-10. Jars and juglets, lt brn; 11-12. Basalt bowls; 13. Rope dec, buff; 14-15. Perforated weights, limestone; 16. Adze, flint.

the site. It seems that during the LR there was a structure or structures close to the spring. West and north-west of this part, in a date-palm grove, is the more ancient site, also adjacent to the Buleibil springs. There are no construction remains here, but there are a considerable number of Chalcolithic sherds, among them V-shaped bowls and large basins with a thickened rim and rope ornamentation.

Pottery: Chalcolithic – 95%; Late Roman – 5%.

Flint: 37 items, Chalcolithic, see Appendix A.

Stone: 2 Chalcolithic basalt bowls (Fig. 69: 11-12), 2 Chalcolithic limestone weights (Fig. 69: 14-15), and a Roman basalt bowl (Eitam 2005: fig. 464: 4).

Additional surveys: none.

Additional Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 10.



Site 25: 20-19/09/1

KHIRBET HISAS ED-DEIR

Israel grid: 2004/1991

UTM grid: 7383/5861

Elevation: 235 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient and on map

Site type: small

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: plain

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: silt

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: 'Ein Buleibil

(163), 500 m distant

Nearest road: Shechem–Abu Sus (B8),

1.5 km distant

Visit: Jan. 1990; 16 sherds

This is a small ruin in the plain, about 2.5 km north-east of Meḥola. The site is situated in a swampy zone, surrounded by drainage channels and many springs.

Fortification activities by the army totally destroyed the small tell and created a long elevated rampart, aligned south-west–north-east. The rampart is about 150 m long with a deep drainage channel along it. Along the sides of the rampart are large deposits of earth and stones.

Mellaart (1962: site 66), who surveyed the place, writes: “natural hill with Arabic occupation – ploughed fair size. Periods of occupation: One neolithic/chalcolithic type flint. Medieval Arabic (Painted) and blue/green glazed sherd.”

Gophna and Porath (1972: site 46) described a small ruin with building



70. The site at Khirbet Hisas ed-Deir, view to the south-east, 1990. The location of the site is on top of the rampart by the jeep (A. Zertal).

remains and pottery dated to the IA II, Byz (main period) and MA.

The place is not mentioned by Guérin or the British Survey.

Pottery (summary of the different surveys): Late Roman; Byzantine (main period); Early Moslem; Middle Ages.

Additional surveys: Mellaart 1962: site 66; de Contenson 1964: 4●; Mittmann 197●: site 344; Gophna and Porath 1972: site 46.

Site 26: 19-19/78/1

TELL EL-BEIDHA-SHAMSIYEH

Israel grid: 1978/1986	Soil quality: 5
UTM grid: 7358/5855	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 170 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: about 20
Name type: ancient and on map	Nearest water source: 'Ein Shams (169), 300 m distant
Site type: tell	Nearest road: Beit She'an-Jericho (B10), 500 m distant
Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha)	Visit: June 2000; 50 sherds
Topography: plain	
Rock type: Dead Sea Group	
Soil type: silt, swamp	

This is a new Arab village spread over a low tell, located about 1.5 km north-west of Meḥola.

There are about 40 dwellings in the village scattered over the tell, which rises 2–3 m above the plain. North of the village are large orchards belonging to Meḥola, and around it many water and drainage canals.

When digging for house foundations in the village, many old building stones and an abundance of sherds were extracted. Apparently, the low tell was a fairly large EBA site in the floodplain east of Tell el-Iḥammeh, from which survived structures (their foundations were covered by alluvial soil), and perhaps also a fortification wall around the tell.

In the British Survey map are marked ruins north-east of Tell Iḥammeh and next to 'Ein el-Beida. The site does not appear in Guérin's map.

Mellaart (1962), who surveyed the place, mentions two sites: Tell esh-Shamsiyeh (Mellaart 1962: site 69), and Tell 'Ain Beida (Mellaart 1962: site 70). Of the first one he writes: "Several rises – about 2 m. high, partly ploughed. Periods of occupation: Medieval Arabic, some Roman". About the second one he writes: "Medium size tel (?) or hill, walls overgrown. Periods of occupation: Neolithic/Chalcolithic/EB type masses of flint – up to T. Shamsiyeh, EB. Med. Arabic pottery."

Tzori (1977: site 54) describes: "A tell, 1 km north of Tell el-Iḥammeh. Around it thickets... with some springs. Nearby is a small hill, 70×150 m. On top of it... were found many Early Bronze Age sherds... some Byzantine shards were also found."

Mittmann (1970: site 341) also notes MBA II and MA sherds at the site.

East of Khirbet el-Beida, connected to it, is Khirbet Shamsiyeh. Here also are 40–50 new structures, around which LR and Byz sherds were gathered. In the

British Survey map 'Ein Shamsiyeh is shown north of 'Ein el-Beida, with no indication of an ancient site.

Pottery (summary of the different surveys): Early Bronze I-II; Middle Bronze; Late Roman; Byzantine; Early Moslem; Middle Ages.

Flint: 3 items, EB, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: Mellaart 1962: sites 69-70; de-Contenson 1964: 40; Tzori 1977: sites 54-55; Mittmann 1970: sites 338-341.

Additional Bibliography: Abel 1913: 222; Bar 2014a: site 13.



Site 27: 19-19/99/3

TELL ED-DEIR (2)

Israel grid: 1998/1991

UTM grid: 7378/5861

Elevation: 215 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: the nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: plain

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: silt

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: 'Ein ed-Deir
(179a), at the site

Nearest road: Shechem–Abu Sus (B8),
1.3 km distant

Visit: Jan. 2000; 100 sherds

This is a site on a low elevation within a cultivated field, about 500 m north of Tell ed-Deir (1), and 1.5 km north-east of Shamsiyeh.

In the fields north of Tell ed-Deir (1) are concentrations of building stones and a large sherd scatter. It is very likely that the site was an extension of the settlement at Tell ed-Deir (1).

Pottery: Chalcolithic – (?); Byzantine – 20%; Middle Ages – 80%.

Flint: 12 items, Chalcolithic, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.

Additional Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 12.

Site 28: 19-19/98/1

TELL ED-DEIR (1)

In the British Survey map ed-Deir or Umm el-Amdan

Israel grid: 1999/1986

UTM grid: 7378/5856

Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient and on map

Site type: tell

Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)

Topography: plain

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: silt

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: vegetables

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: 'Ein ed-Deir
(179a), 100 m distantNearest road: Shechem–Abu Sus (B8),
1 km distant

Visits: Feb. 1990, 2002; 147 sherds

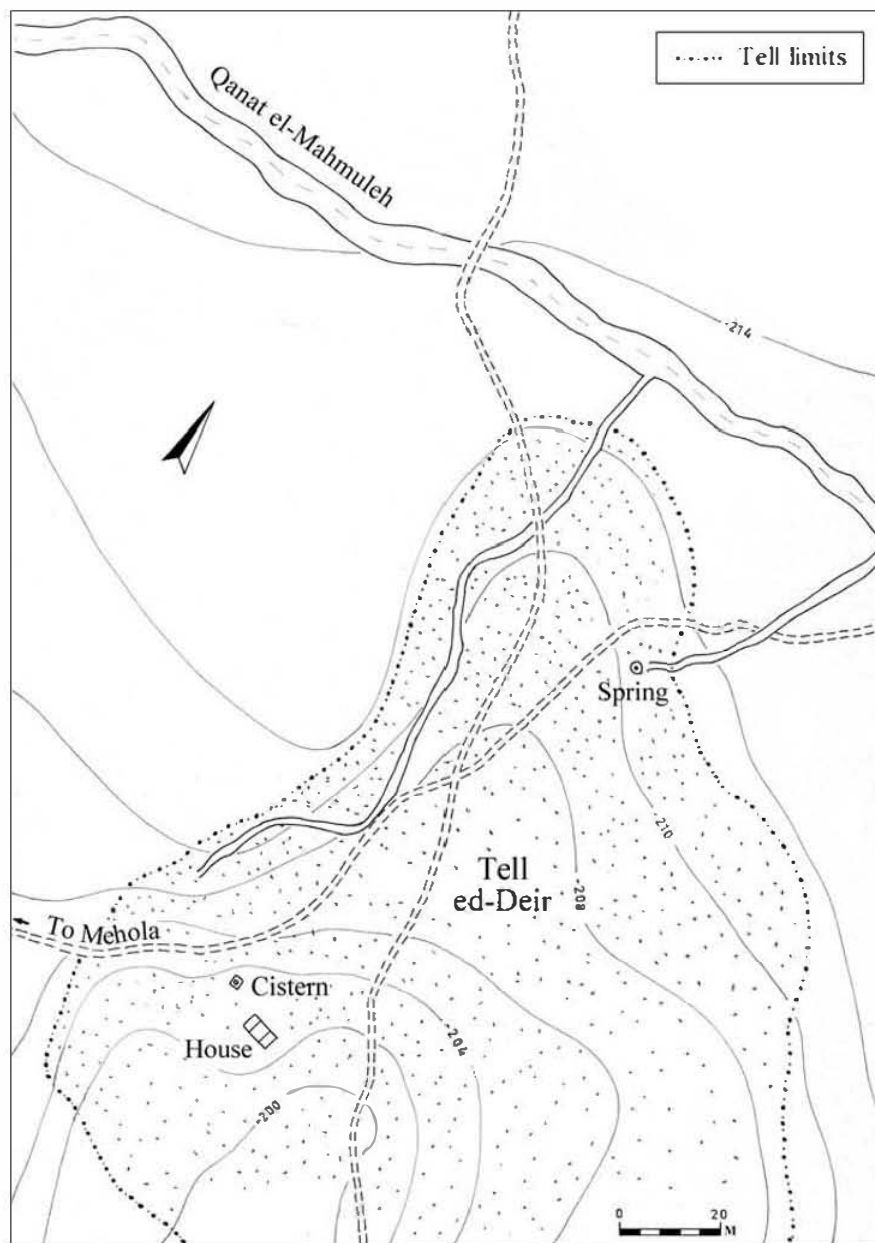
This is a flat tell in a marshy area at the south of Beit She'an Valley, about 1.5 km north-east of Melhola. The tell is in a flat vegetable-growing area. Next to it is a small eucalyptus wood and a spring – 'Ein ed-Deir. There is a view to the lower terrace of the Jordan, the eastern Jordan Valley and the 'Iraq el-Hamam ridge area.

The tell rises several metres above the marshy zone, and north of it passes the Qanat el-Mahmuleh water channel. The tell is located on the northern tip of a low spur, sloping eastward in several steps, next to a local road junction.



71. View of Tell ed-Deir (1), to the south, 1990 (A. Zertal).

Over the surface of the site were traced remains of wall foundations 60 cm wide built of pebbles. In the western part is a single modern concrete building. In the field to the east a considerable number of large and coarse MA sherds was collected.



72. Plan of Tell ed-Deir (1), 2002.

The British Survey notes two sites here: ed-Deir and Umm el-Amdan, “Ed Deir (Q m). -The northern site by the seven springs in the Jordan valley. This name is applied to a ruined wall by the spring. The real site seems to be at Umm el ‘Amdan.” (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 236). Ed-Deir appears in the British map west of ‘Ein Qurein. Umm el-Amdan is described as: “Umm el ‘Amdan (Q m). -Scattered stones and traces of considerable ruin, several fallen pillar shafts. The place was all covered with mallows and other flowers when visited.” (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 247).

Apparently there has been confusion of the names of the springs in the British Survey map, or the modern names do not fit the traditional ones. The abundance of springs in the area may be the reason for the confusion.

Mittmann surveyed the site (Mittmann 1970: sites 342 and 343) and describes a large low tell called Umm el-‘Amdan. In its lower part there was a modern village (no longer existing) with pottery dating to the EB I-II, MBA, Hel, EM, MA, and Ottoman periods. EB I pottery was also found 700 m to the north of the village.

It is likely that a site noted by Gophna and Porath (1972: site 50) is Tell ed-Deir: “A ruin on a low hilltop, at the fringes of the Beit She’an Valley. Its area is about 2 dunams (2000 sq. m). The foundations of the structures are built from fieldstones. The sherds are from the Israelite II, Byzantine (the bulk of the find) and Medieval periods.” We did not find any IA sherds, and suggest that the main period of occupation was MA.

It is obvious that Christian religious activity took place here, perhaps in the Byz period; hence the name ed-Deir.

Pottery (summary of the various surveys): Chalcolithic; Early Bronze I-II; Middle Bronze; Persian; Hellenistic; Late Roman; Byzantine; Early Moslem; Middle Ages; Ottoman.

Flint: 4 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: Mittmann 1970: sites 342-343; Gophna and Porath 1972: site 50.

Additional Bibliography: Abel 1913: 222; Bar 2014a: site 12.

Site 29: 20-19/08/1

EL-MAHMULEH

Israel grid: 2005/1983

UTM grid: 7384/5854

Elevation: 220 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: plain

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: silt

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: 'Ein

el-Mahmuleh (179c),

200 m distant

Nearest road: Shechem–Abu Sus (B8),

500 m distant

Visit: Jan. 1990; 9 sherds

This is a small site on a moderate slope descending eastwards in the centre of the *Ghor* marshes, about 2 km north-east of Meḥola.

The site is next to an unpaved road leading from Tell ed-Deir (1) south-east to the Jordan border fence. Nowadays there are vegetable gardens and fields. Sherds and building stones and a fragment of a carved column section were collected. The vegetation coverage during the visit made it difficult to determine the size of the site.

The site was a Byz farm or cluster of houses.

Pottery: Byzantine – 100%.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 30: 19-19/77/1

TELL EL-ḤAMMEH

Israel grid: 1973/1977

UTM grid: 7352/5847

Elevation: 98 m b.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: appears on map as a historical site

Site type: fortified tell

Area: 30 dunams (3 ha)

Topography: valley fringes

Rock type: Lisan marl

Soil type: silt

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: 'Ein el-Ḥammeh

(116), 200 m distant

Nearest road: Beit She'an–Jericho

(B10), next to the site

Visits: April 1986 and additional ones,

April 2001 - plan; 128 sherds

This is a high kidney-shaped tell in the south-western fringes of the Beit She'an Valley, about 1.5 km north-west of Meḥola and close to the Beit She'an–Jericho road. It is situated in a small inner valley, where Wadi el-I-Hammeh enters the Beit She'an Valley. West of it are two springs, one of them flowing hot water (from which is derived the name of the tell).

The site rises about 30 m above its surroundings. Its slopes are especially steep, resulting from severe erosion. In the southern slope is a deep cleft, dividing the tell into two. East of the tell, in the direction of the Beit She'an–Jericho road, is a low terrace; perhaps a lower city. In the valley around the site, as well as the springs, was a fairly large Byz to MA settlement (see Zertal 2008: site 67).

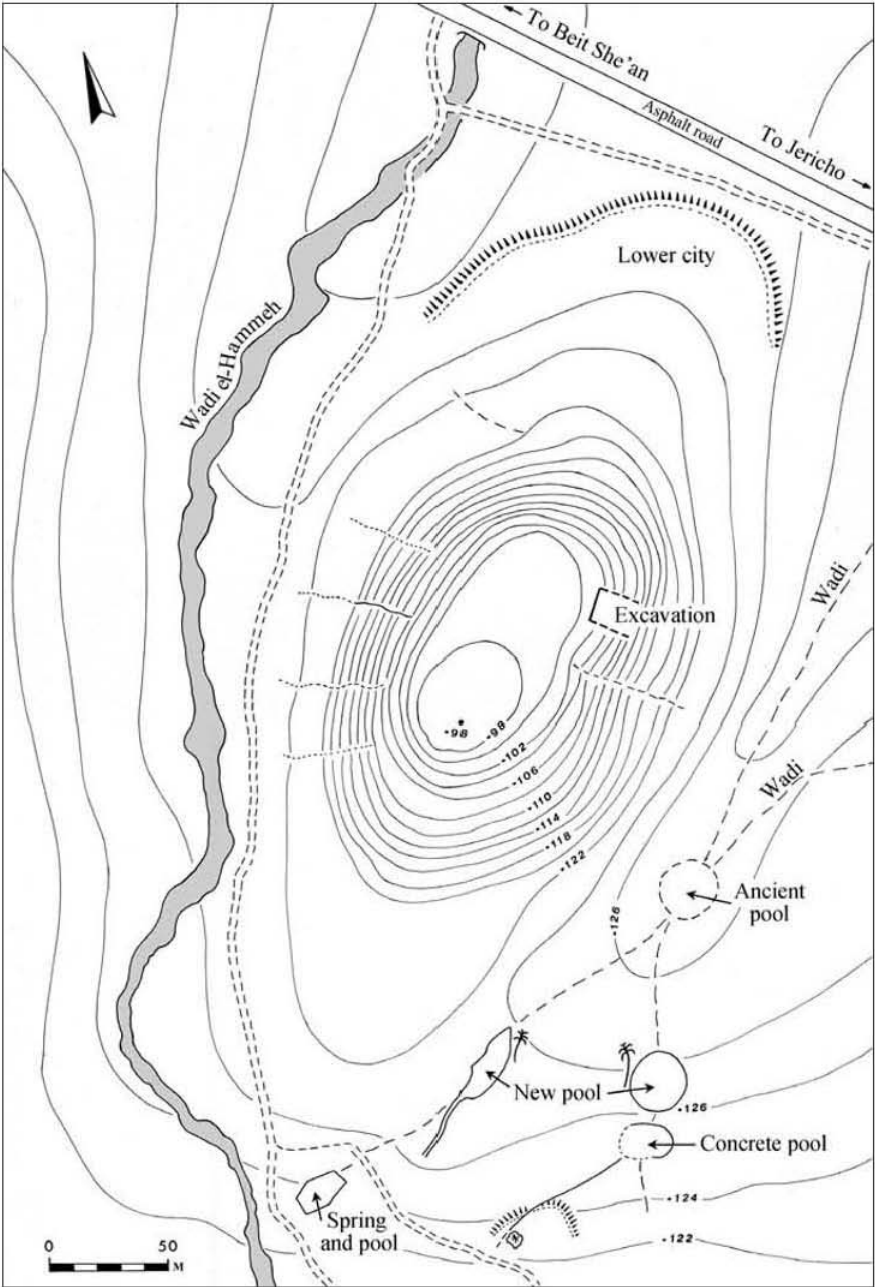
The site is not mentioned by Guérin. The British Survey describes it as: "Tell el Hammeh - A large artificial mound near a good spring." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 246).

Albright (1925a: 18) visited the place in April 1925, reporting: "Tell el-Hammeh is a fine high mound, in a commanding situation, with the same type of pottery – Late Bronze and Early Iron, first phase – though it seems to have been occupied rather longer than the other mounds of the district. There can be no doubt, as a result of our careful study of the mound, that it is the Hammath of the Egyptian texts of the Nineteenth Dynasty, especially the new Sethos I stela of Beisan, according to which Sethos intervened in a conflict between Pahel (Pella) and Hammath on the one side, and Beth-shal (Beth-shan) and Rehob on the other. In a previous trip the writer visited the site of Pella, Khirbet Fahil, and found that the Graeco-Roman town was built on a fine mound of the Bronze and Iron Ages. We have now succeeded in identifying its ally, Hammath, since the other possibilities, Hammath of Naphtali, el-I-Hammeh on the Yarmfik, and Tell el-Hammeh near Pella (a purely Byzantine site) have all been examined before and found wanting."

Mellaart (1962: site 71), who surveyed the place, writes: "Medium size tel, great height, very steep-grass overgrown, tombs at south side-skirt and walls. Across wadi N, Khirbe and walls. Periods of occupation: T. Hammeh – EB, LB/ Iron Age, Roman Byzantine, Medieval Arabic...city of Hamma? Mentioned by Seti I? Fort, guarding plain of Beisan, important site."

In the Emergency Survey (Gophna and Porath 1972: site 55) the place was defined as "Tell, kidney-shaped, on a hilltop in the fringe of the Beth Shean Valley. Its area is about 5 dunams. North-west of it is a khirbe, about 1.5 dunams..."

Tzori (1977: site 53) defined it as "A high tell, 120×90 m, from it a good view over broad areas of Beit She'an Valley and the Jordan plain. Around it remains of ancient structures, spread over an area of ca. 500×500 m. The tell appears in all the maps and is mentioned in many travellers' accounts and academic



73. Plan of Tell el-Hammeh, 2001.



74. Aerial view of Tell el-Hammeh, looking north-east, 2013 (A. Solomon).

literature...The name does not appear in the Bible, but there is no doubt that the tell continued to be a central site during this period. During the Byzantine period there was a flourishing settlement.”

The excavations: Three excavation seasons were conducted from 1985 to 1988 by Terler, Kahil and Lipovitz (see Bibliography). Their main results are:

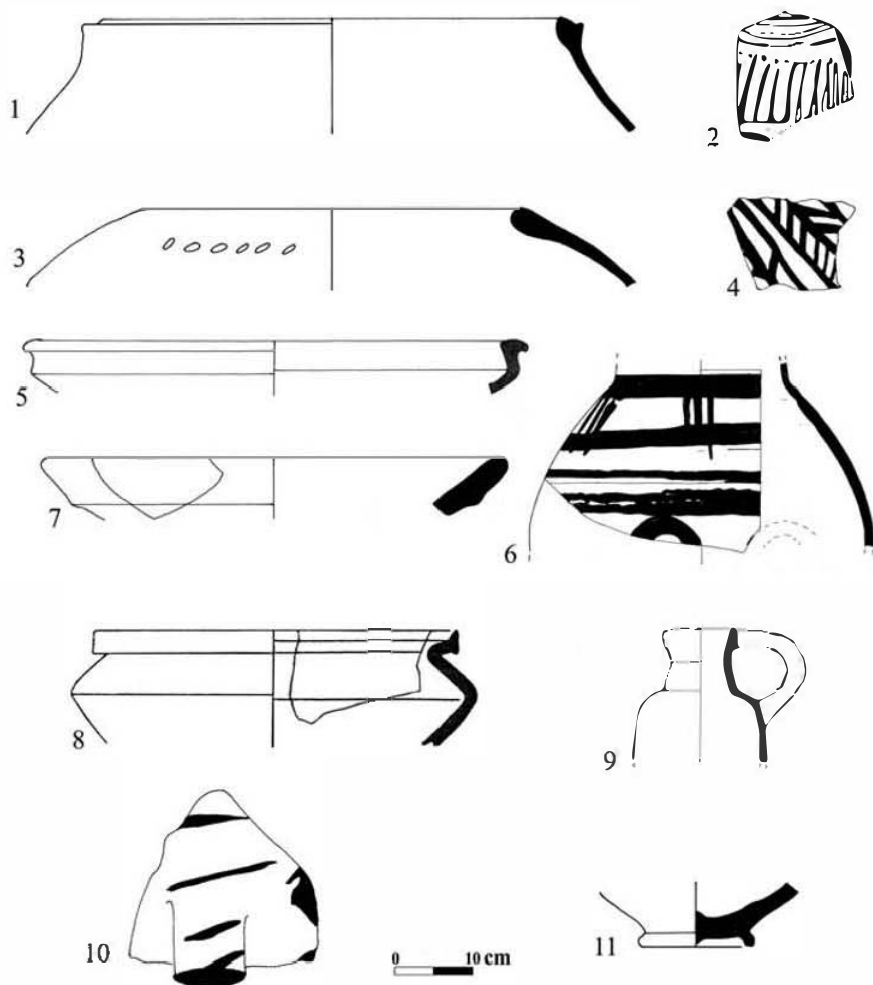
In step M, below the summit, IA IIc layers have been found (8th–7th centuries BCE). These contained a stone structure and next to it a brick structure, built on the destruction layer of the 9th–8th centuries BCE. Among the noteworthy finds was a ‘Cuthean’ bowl on a tripod basis, and loom weights. This destruction layer was exposed on the lowest step, L, and beneath it was another destruction layer from the 10th century BCE. A four-room house was also exposed, with 40 ceramic vessels, among them an ornamented kernos, a zoomorphic artifact, a krater with eight handles and horned animals, ‘black on red’ juglets, and other items. In other structures were found more artifacts, among them alabaster vessels, many seals and *bullae*, and many weights and tools for cloth weaving. The excavators assume this destruction occurred during Shishak’s campaign at the end of the 10th century BCE.

Four IA I phases were unearthed in steps J–K. A structure with four parallel rooms, destroyed by fire, and containing pottery *in situ*, was excavated. In a sampling trench were found sections of the fortifications dated to MB II, which had been almost entirely washed away over time.

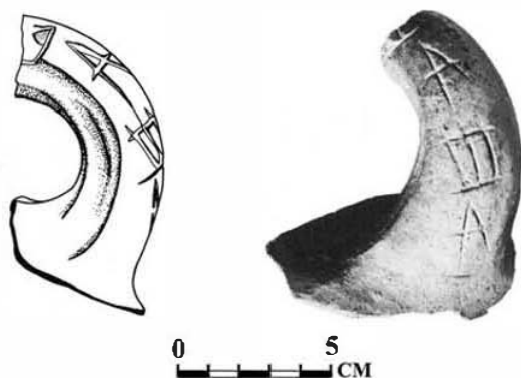
In a return visit to the site in 2016, the remains of a burial ground were discovered on a low spur 300 m south-east of the tell (Israel grid 19772/19760).

The entire area was extensively robbed, and the remains of at least 15 grave openings were visible on the surface. Most of the graves were of the rock-cut type, with one or two burial chambers. There were also shaft graves. The pottery found in the robbed pits mostly dates to the Byzantine period, but a few Iron Age sherds were also found.

Pottery (summary of the various surveys): Middle Bronze II; Late Bronze I-III; Iron I-II; Persian; Early and Late Roman; Byzantine; Early Moslem.



75. Pottery from Tell el-Hammeh: 1. Krater, brn, MB II; 2, 4, 6, 10. Jars painted sherds, LB; 3. HM, gr, MB II; 5. Bowl, lt gr, Ir II; 7. Bowl, lt gr, Pers; 8. CP A, dk brn, Ir I; 9. Jug, brn, Ir I; 11. Base of bowl, buff, LB-Ir I.



76. Engraving on a jar handle 'to Ahab', Ir II, found during the Emergency Survey, 1968 (Gophna and Porath 1972: 214).

Additional surveys: Albright 1925a: 18; Mellaart 1962: site 71; de Contenson 1964: 40-41; Mittmann 1970: 129; Gophna and Porath 1972: site 55; Mittmann 1970: site 337; Tzori 1977: site 53.

Additional Bibliography: Yeivin 1962: 24; Aharoni 1964; Cahill and Tarler 1993 (with additional Bibliography); Bar 2014a: site 117; *NEAEHL* 5: 2096 (for additional Bibliography).



Site 31: 20-19/07/1

EJ-JOBEH

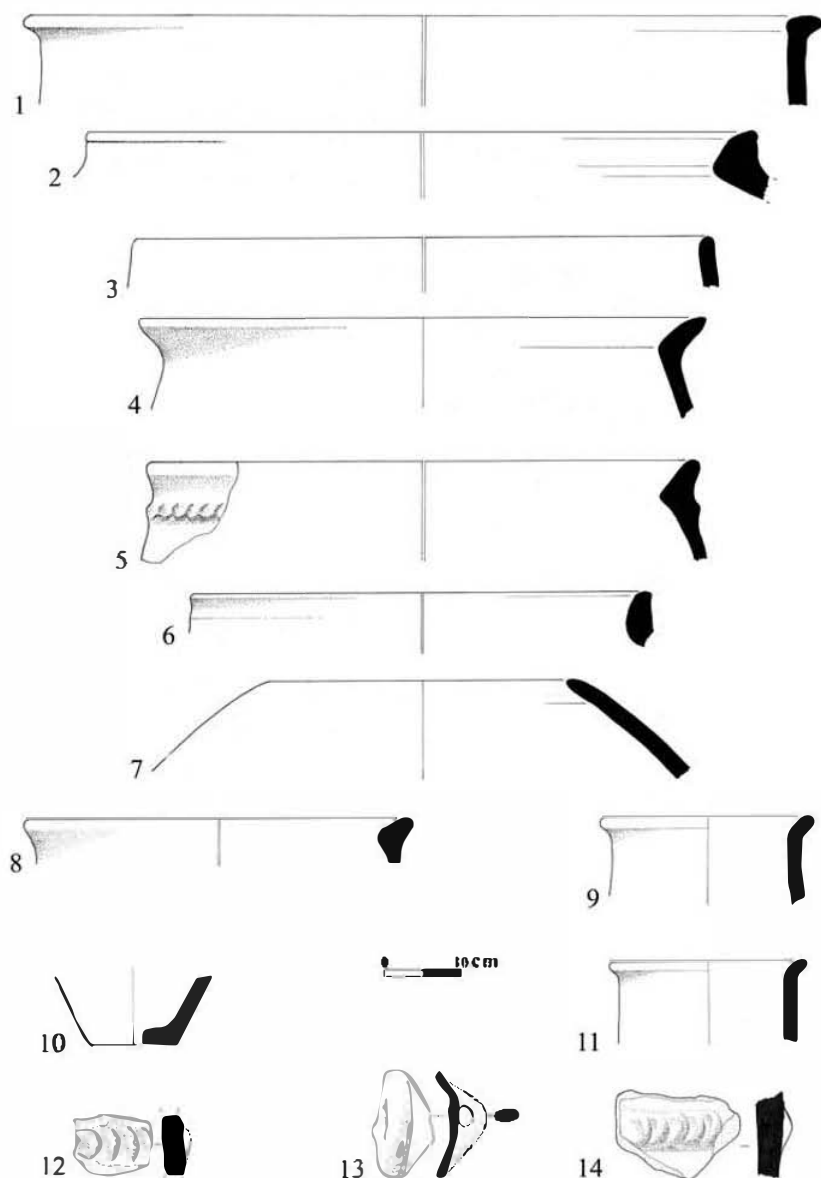
Israel grid: 2006/1977
 UTM grid: 7386/5848
 Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.
 Name type: nearest place
 Site type: large
 Area: 60 dunams (6 ha)
 Topography: plain
 Rock type: Lisan formation
 Soil type: silt

Soil quality: 8
 Cultivation: field crops
 Cisterns: none
 Nearest water source: 'Ein
 el-Mahmuleh (179c),
 400 m distant
 Nearest road: Shechem–Abu Sus (B8),
 next to the site
 Visit: Jan. 1990; 200 sherds

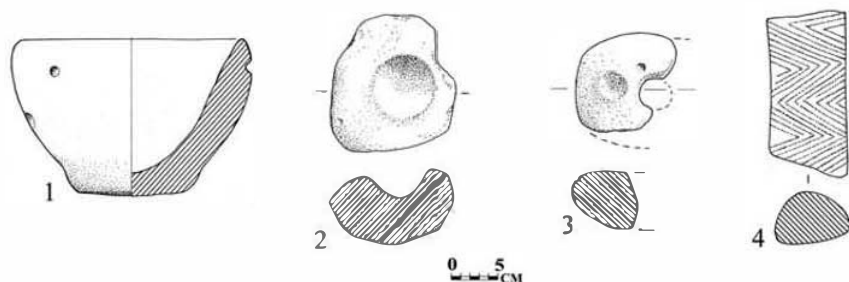
This is a large site over a very moderate slope in the *Ghor*, descending from the Meholá plain eastwards to the lowest terrace of the Jordan Valley, 1.8 km south-east of Shamsiyeh.

The site is near to a road junction: one branch leads north and the other east

to Tell Abu Sus. In the centre of the site, which is in a large ploughed field, is an elongated rampart constructed by the army. It includes many building stones, cleared from the site's houses, and many sherds. In the field east of the rampart are many more stones and an abundance of pottery and basalt and stone tools. Such a scatter is also found west of the rampart.



77. Pottery from ej-Jobeh: 1-2, 8. Basins, buff; 3, 7. HM, buff; 4-6. Jordan Valley pithoi, buff; 8-9, n. Jars, buff; 10. Base, buff; 12, 14. Rope dec, buff; 13. Lug handle, buff.



78. Groundstone tools from ej-Jobeh: 1. Bowl, basalt; 2-3. Querns; 4. Leg of a fenestrated incense burner.

This site is the largest and richest Chalcolithic site in the southern Beit She'an Valley, and has a similar layout pattern to other Chalcolithic sites found in the floodplains of the eastern and western Jordan Rift Valley. These sites are located in the plains close to sources of water. They tend to have large open spaces between the houses (e.g. the Fazael sites - Bar 2013b; 2014a; 2014b).

Pottery: Chalcolithic – 100%.

Flint: 39 items, Chalcolithic, see Appendix A.

Stone: Two basalt bowls (Fig. 78: 1), a leg of a fenestrated incense burner decorated with triangular incisions (Fig. 78: 4), 2 querns (Fig. 78: 2, 3), and limestone grinding slabs.

Additional surveys: none.

Additional Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 15.



Site 32: 2019/16/1

KHIRBET ES-SAKUT

In the British Survey map Ain es-Sakut, in Guérin's – Kh. Sakout

Israel grid: 2015/1968

UTM grid: 7395/5839

Elevation: 216 m b.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map as a historical site

Site type: tell

Area: 40 dunams (4 ha)

Topography: plain

Rock type: Lisan

Soil type: silt

Soil quality: g

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

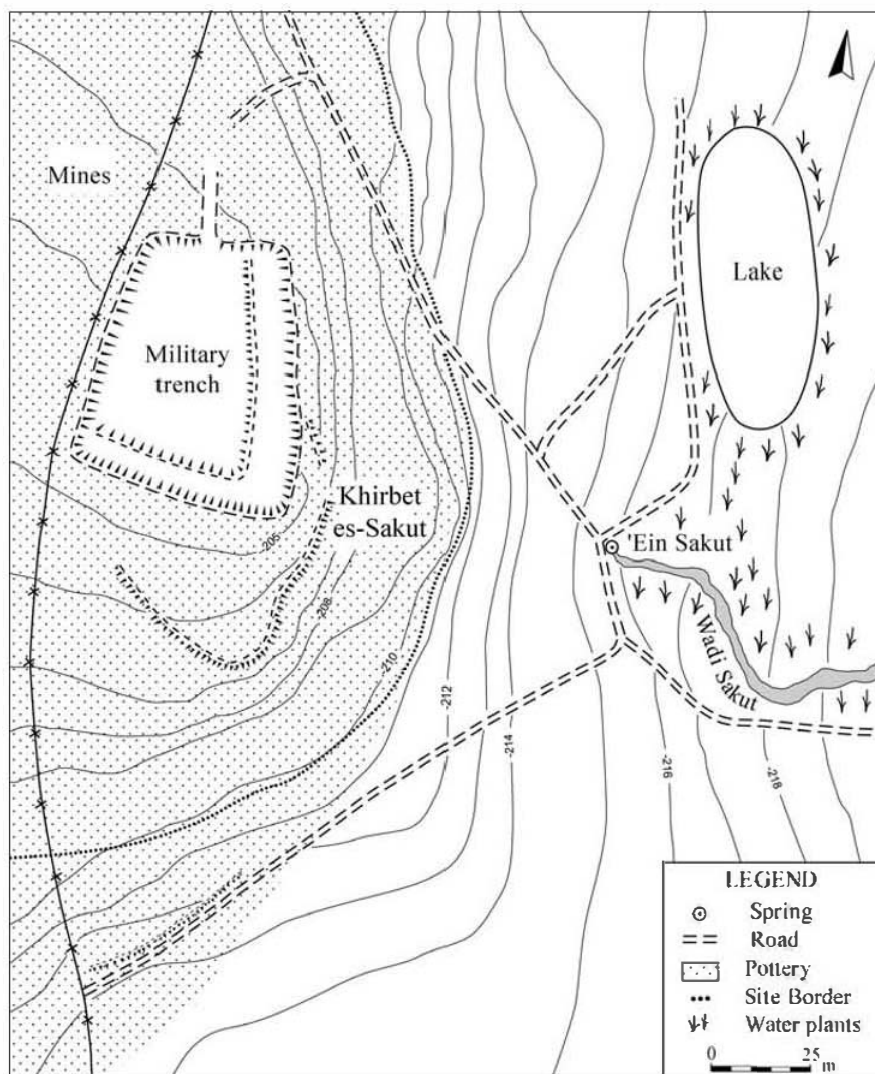
Nearest water source: 'Ein Sakut (167), at the site

Nearest road: Shechem–Abu Sus (B8), 400 m distant

Visits: Dec. 1990, plan – Oct. 2003; 100 sherds

This is a large low tell at the south-eastern fringes of the Beit She'an Valley, about 700 m west of the River Jordan and about 2.5 km east of Melhola. The tell rises slightly above its vicinity, and there is a fairly good view from it to the expanses of the Jordan Valley, east and west of the river. Around the site lay large cultivated areas, and at its foot, in the east, flows 'Ein Sakut. The spring water now flows into several large pools, around which is lush vegetation of cane and reed.

Over the tell and its immediate vicinity large quantities of sherds were collected and a few stone walls were seen. During military activities, trenches



79. Plan of Khirbet es-Sakut, 2003.



80. Khirbet es-Sakut, view to west from 'Ein Sakut, 1996 (M. Einav).

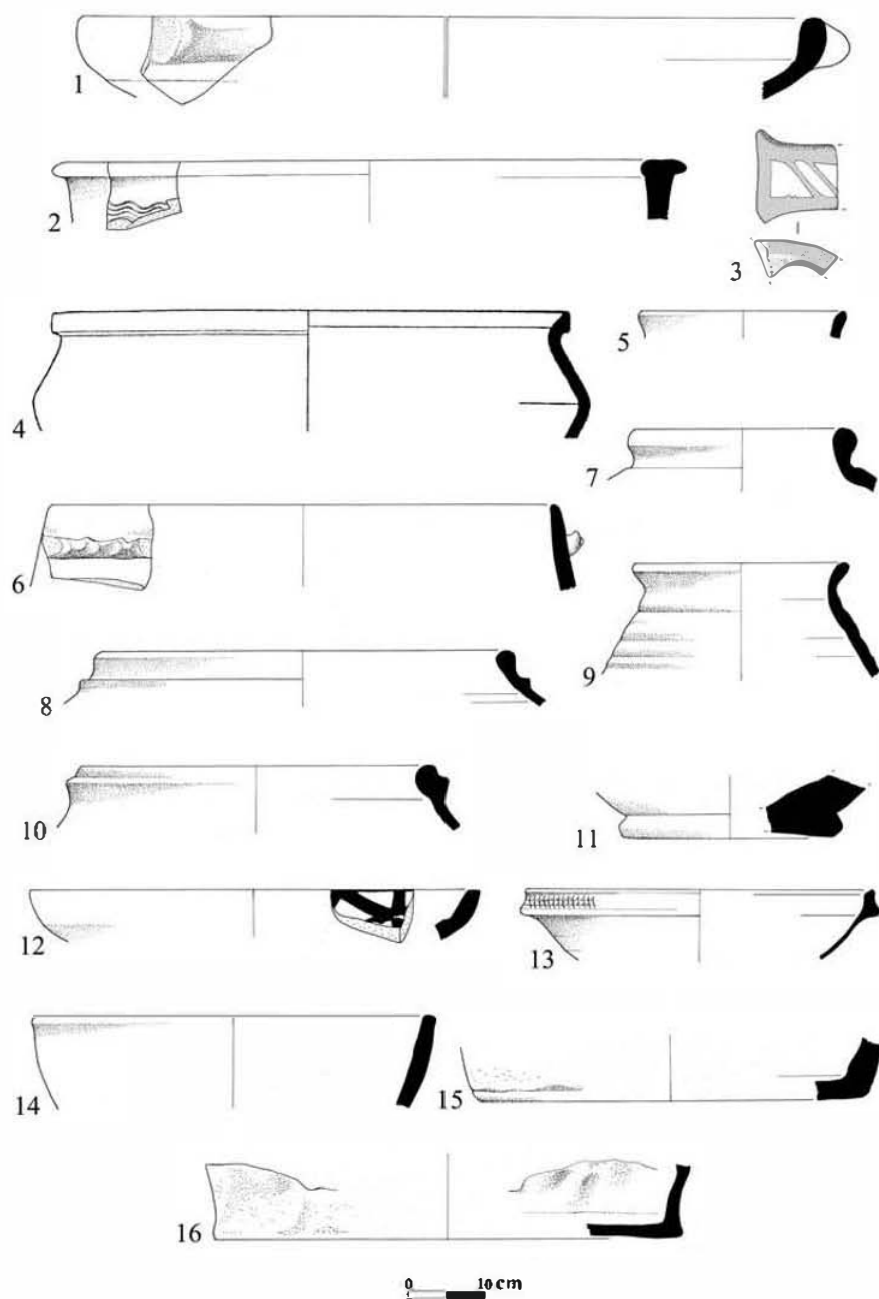
were dug in the tell, altering its original form. At its centre is a trench about 2.5 m deep, about 75 m long and about 4 m wide, perhaps intended as an antitank obstacle. The entire western part is mined.

Within the limits of the present tell, sherds of the later periods – LR to MA – are especially abundant. Sherds from the Chalcolithic to the IA III were collected in the areas north of the site, up to a distance of 500 m from its centre. It thus seems that the original settlement spread over a much broader area than that of the present tell.

Robinson visited on May 1852, describing it thus: "...we came at 10.20 to Sakut. Here is seen merely the ruin of a common village, a few fountains of unhewn stones. The eastern bank of the lower Jordan Valley opposite to us was precipitous, apparently nearly a hundred and fifty or two hundred feet high; and the river was running close under it about half a mile distant from us"... "Near the foot of the low bluff of Sakut, towards the east, there breaks out a beautiful fountain of pure and sparkling water, under the shade of a thicket of fig trees. Here we took our lunch, and enjoyed both the water and the shade... Burckhardt was the first to hear of the name Sakut in this region; but he did not himself see the spot." (Robinson and Smith 1856: 309–310).

Guérin (1969: 269–274), who visited on April 1870, describes the environment, and remarks on the lack of architectural remains, in contrast to the mass of sherds. He also discusses the identification of the city (see Chapter 2).

The site is not described by the British Survey. In the historical discussion in Sheet XII it is said: "Beit She'an xxxiii. Robinson has proposed to place this at Sakut, but Mr. Grove argues that it should be sought east of Jordan. The name Sakut is radically different from Succoth. In the fourteenth century Marino



81. Pottery from Khirbet es-Sakut: 1. Bowl, brn, bar handle, Ir II; 2. Bowl, gr, wavy orn, EM; 3. Jug handle, rd over brn, Byz; 4, 8. CPs A, dk brn, Ir I; 5. Small bowl, gr, Ir II; 6. HM, buff, Chal; 7. Jar, brn, Ir II; 9. Jar, brn, Ir I; 10. CP, dk gr, Ir II; 11. Base, buff, MB II; 12. Bowl, green glazing over yel, MA; 13. Bowl, LR; 14. Bowl, buff, MB II; 15. Base, buff, Chal; 16. Base, buff, EB.

Sanuto marks Succoth on his map just where Sakut now exists.” (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 231).

Mellaart (1962: site 68), who surveyed the place, writes: “Natural hill and good spring—river—modern houses. Periods of occupation: Roman, Byzantine, Medieval Arabic.”

In 1967 Gophna and Porath (1972: site 59) surveyed the place, writing: “A khirbe on the edge of a ridge, above the majesty of the Jordan. Its area is about 3 dunams. Foundations of structures, built of rough stones, can be seen on the surface. A 3 m-wide wall, built of small rough stones, can be seen on the eastern slope. Pottery find: Iron I (several), Iron II, Byzantine (the large part), and Medieval.”

The ‘wall’ mentioned by Gophna and Porath can no longer be identified.

Pottery: Chalcolithic – 6%; Early Bronze I-II – 8%; Middle Bronze II – 14%; Late Bronze – 8%; Iron I – 11%; Iron II – 10%; Persian – 7%; Hellenistic – 2%; Late Roman – 12%; Byzantine – 6%; Early Moslem – 8%; Middle Ages – 8%.

Identification: Beth Meholā of Eusebius’ Onomasticon (Taylor 2003: 27), and see Chapter 2.

Additional surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972: site 59.

Additional Bibliography: Glueck 1943; Mellaart 1962: site 68; de-Contenson 1964: 42; Ilan 1973: 338; Bar 2014a: site 16.



Site 33: 20-19/27/1

TELL ABU SUS

Israel grid: 2029/1978

UTM grid: 7409/5850

Elevation: 250 m b.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient and on map

Site type: large tell

Area: 30 dunams (3 ha)

Topography: raised and isolated tell

Rock type: Lisan marl

Soil type: marl

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: River Jordan
(112), at the site

Nearest road: Shechem–Abu Sus (B8),
next to the site

Visit: Jan. 2002; 258 sherds

This is a large tell rising well above its surroundings, built on an isolated high hill on the lowest terrace (the *Zor*) in the Jordan Rift Valley. It is located just to the west of the channel of the River Jordan, between the river and the Israeli

of the *Ghor*. About 300 m north of it is the Jordan ford (Maḥdeth Faddalla), and near its eastern slopes is the Abu Sus ford (Maḥdeth Abu Sus).

Before the destructive actions by the army the tell, and apparently the settlement, spread over two hills – western and eastern – rising from the mountainous block of Abu Sus and the saddle between them.

The western hill is about 5 dunams (5000 sq. m) in area. On its summit are the remains of many structures whose foundations are built of pebbles. Below the summit, to the west, is a broad un-surveyed (because of mines) shoulder. In the eastern part of the hill is a deep section, resulting from fortification activities during the 1970s. The section is about 30 m long and 6 m deep. Noticeable in it are remains of five layers, among which are pebbles and beaten earth floors, remains of mud brick walls, hearths, installations and layers of ash. According to the abundant pottery these layers can be dated from the EB to the IA II.

The saddle is ascended from the north-west by a narrow asphalt road. It is about 50×50 m, and the remains in it were damaged by the modern fortification operations.

The remains on the eastern hill have been damaged, and a large modern strongpoint was built on it with trenches and bunkers. From here very steep slopes descend north, east and west, with many sherds scattered on them.

To the north, at the foot of the tell, are several spurs on which remains of structures can be seen. Because of the mines it was not possible to learn their nature, but it seems that the built-up area extended to these areas as well.

The British Survey, reports: "Tell Abu Sus (Q m). A very large artificial mound, standing isolated near Jordan." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 246).

Mellaart (1962: 152-153: table), who visited the tell in 1962, wrote: "Number - 67. Name of site - Tell Abussus. Description of site - Enormous isolated natural rock with occupation on gentle slopes. Water - River Jordan. Arable land - Good land. Periods of occupation - Iron Age, Roman, Byzantine, Medieval Arabic. Size/Importance - esp. Iron Age settlement."

Zobel (1966: 97-101) visited in 1965, and proposed (after Mittmann) identifying the tell with Biblical Abel-Meḥola.

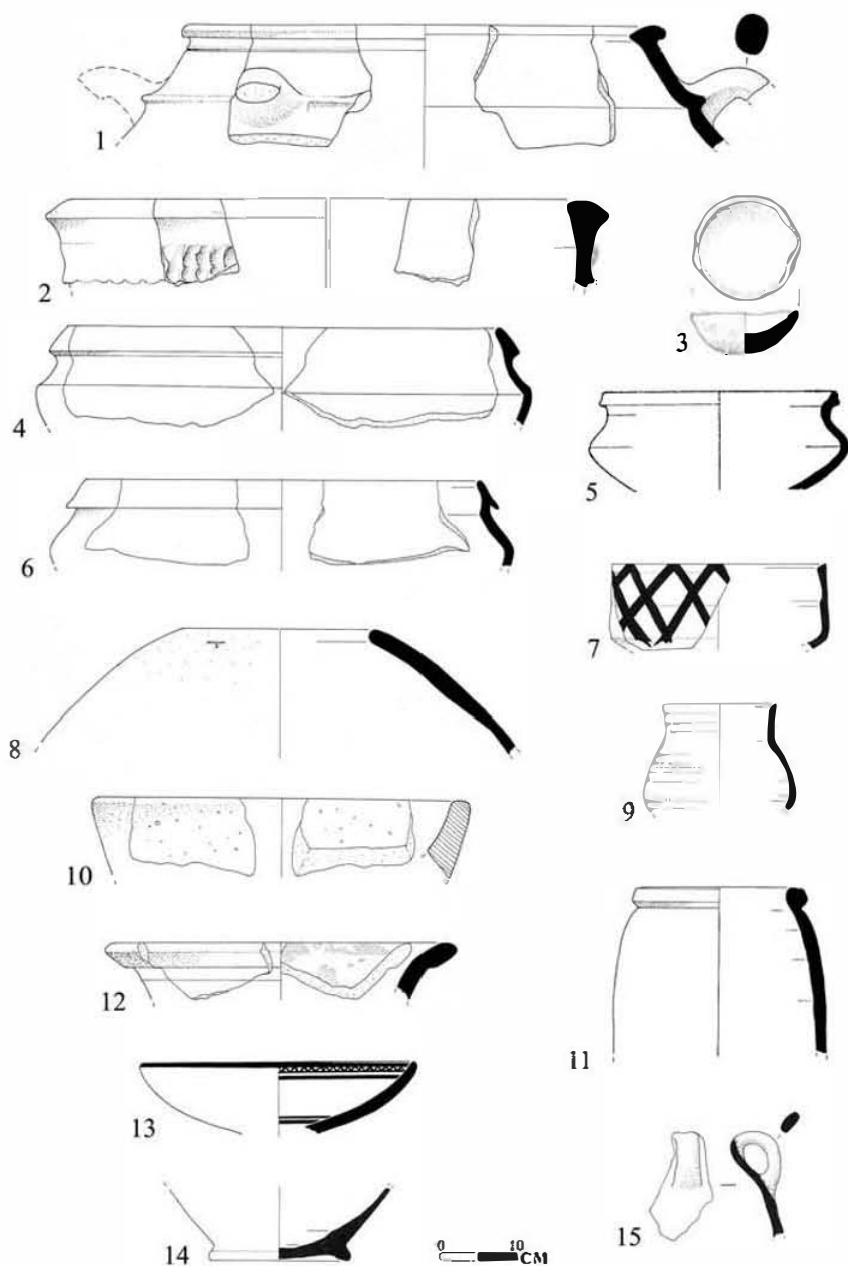
Tzori (1977: site 56) visited on an unknown date, writing: "Tell Abu Sus, above the majesty of the Jordan, is composed of two mounds at the top of a natural hill. Its height above the river is ca. 50 m, and its measurements are ca. 300 m (east-west), and 100 m (north-south)... Late period tombs were dug in the western mound, and the whole site was damaged during Jordanian and Israeli military operations...Remains of structures of pebbles, brought from the river, can be seen all over the site, and a stone wall, 20 m long and 1 m thick, was detected on the eastern mound. Pottery find: Early Bronze, Iron I, Byzantine, Early Moslem, and Medieval."



83. Tell abu Sus, view to the east, 2002. The site is on the tallest summit and the one nearby. The mountain was cut by the military road (M. Einav).



84. View from Tell Abu Sus to the Jordan Zor, to the eastern Jordan Valley and to the Gilead mountains, 2002 (M. Einav).



85. Finds from Tell Abu Sus: 1. Krater, brn, Ir I; 2. Basin, buff, rope dec, Chal/EB; 3. Lamp, lt brn, MB II; 4-6. CPs, dk brn, Ir I; 7. Bowl, rd dec over cream, LB; 8. HM, lt brn, EB; 9. Jug, buff, MB II/LB; 10. Bowl, basalt; 11. Jar, buff, Ir II; 12. Juglet, brn, LR; 13. Bowl, yel glazing, MA; 14. Bowl, buff, MB II; 15. Jug, brn, Ir I-II.

The tell looks like a fortified citadel, overlooking the Jordan fords. Similar citadels perhaps existed in Tell eṣ-Ṣimadi (Site 84), Tell esh-Sheikh Diyab (Zertal 2012a: site 23) and Tell Damia. They are mainly located at the starting points of important roads going west. Tell Abu Sus is at the western exit of the cross-road of Wadi Maliḥ and the road to Shechem (B8).

Pottery (summary of the different surveys): Chalcolithic; Early Bronze I-II; Middle Bronze II; Late Bronze I-II; Iron I-II; Persian; Hellenistic; Early and Late Roman; Byzantine; Early Moslem; Middle Ages.

Flint: 28 items, EB, see Appendix A.

Stone: 2 Chalcolithic basalt bowls; 2 EB lower grinding stones; and a Hel or Byz rounded basalt bowl (Eitam 2005: 684-685).

Identification: The identification with Abel-Meḥola is possible and likely, and see Chapter 2.

Additional surveys: Mellaart 1962: site 67; de-Contenson 1964: 41-42; Zobel 1966; Tzori 1977: site 56.

Additional Bibliography: Tzori 1967; Bar 2014a: site 14.



Site 34: 19-19/96/1

EL-MARMA

Israel grid: 1999/1960

UTM grid: 7379/5830

Elevation: 195 m b.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: medium size

Area: 7 dunams (7000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: Wadi Maliḥ
(103), 300 m distant

Nearest road: Shechem–Abu Sus (B8),
next to the site

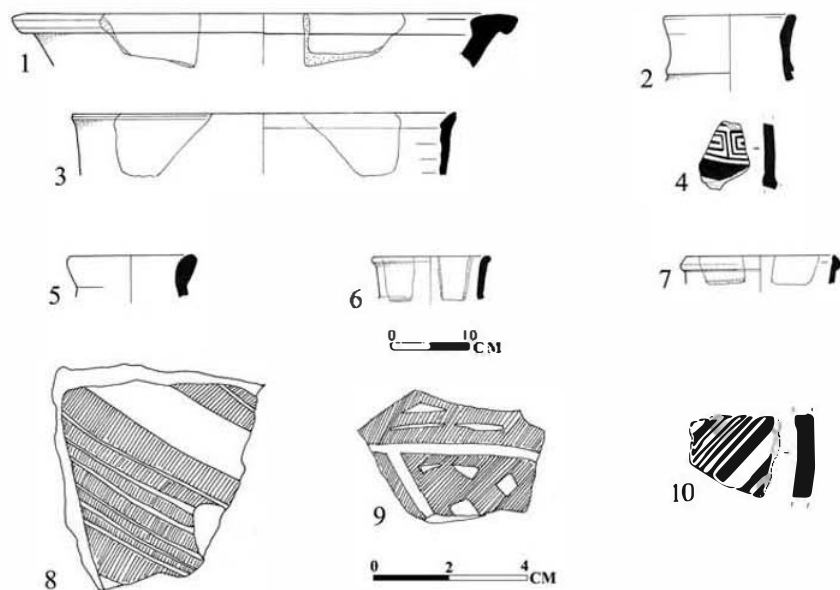
Visits: Nov. 1988, June 2000;
54 sherds

This is a site on a medium-sized hilltop on the southern bank of Wadi Maliḥ, 1 km north-north-west of the settlement of Shadmot Meḥola.

The hilltop is part of the range of hills along Wadi Maliḥ on the south, close to where it joins the southern plain of the Beit She'an Valley. On the hilltop are 10 to 12 walls, which do not meet to create clear structures. It seems that a central structure once stood here, with, perhaps additional ones around



86. The site of el-Marina, view to the south-west. In the foreground is Wadi Malih valley, 2003 (M. Einav).



87. Pottery from el-Marina: 1. Bowl, gr, MA; 2. Jar, pk, ER; 3. Bowl, buff, Hel; 4, 8-10. Dec sherds, violet over cream, MA; 5, 6. Jugs, brn, Rom; 7. Jug, brn, Byz.

it. Along the slopes of the hilltop's perimeter was a wall 1 m thick, possibly enclosing the settlement. All the walls are built of two rows of stones with large stones at the corners.

Along the hilltop perimeter are dug a number of army positions, from which sherds and glass fragments were collected.

In April 1870 Guérin (1969: 275) passed through the region and mentioned a group of small tells (Kharbet Tleilat el-Maleh). Possibly one of them was el-Marma.

The site gives a good view of Wadi Maliḥ and the Beit She'an–Jericho road. It is possible that there was a citadel or fortified site here guarding the road.

Pottery: Persian – 12%; Hellenistic – 18%; Early Roman – 10%; Late Roman – 23%; Byzantine – 20%; Middle Ages – 17%.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 35: 20-19/06/1

WADI MALIḤ

Israel grid: 2002/1963

UTM grid: 7382/5834

Elevation: 212 m b.s.l., 25 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop above the wadi

Rock type: Lisan formation

Soil type: brown forest and silt

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi Maliḥ
(103), at the site

Nearest roads: Shechem–Abu Sus (B8)
and Jericho–Beit She'an (B10),
next to the site

Visit: Feb. 1990; 25 sherds

This is a site on a prominent hilltop 1.3 km north of Shadmot Meḥola. It is located close to the point where the Beit She'an–Jericho road crosses the west bank of Wadi Maliḥ

The hilltop area is 1 dunam (1000 sq. m). Steep slopes descend from it eastward, northward and southward. The westward slope is somewhat more moderate, and is cut by the modern road. At the summit are two or three poorly constructed walls. Sherds dating to the IA period were scattered on the hilltop and its slopes.

The site appears to be a small fort, which guarded the Wadi Maliḥ junction of the road from Beit She'an to Jericho (B10) and the road going east to the

Jordan fords (to Tell Abu Sus - B8).

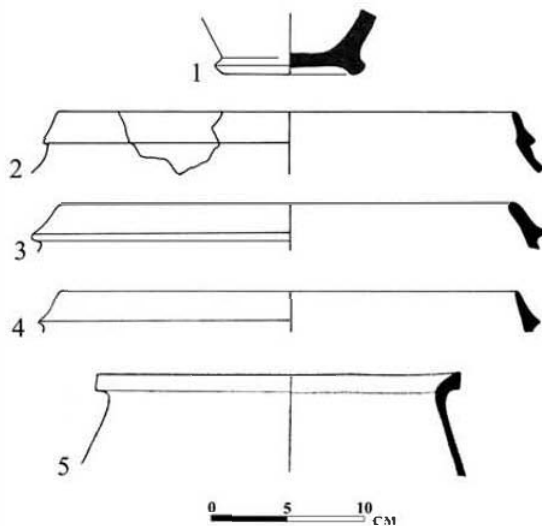
Nearby, south of the site, between E. P. -212 and the hilltop south of it, Byz sherd concentrations were found.

Pottery: In the site: Iron I – 100%. In its surroundings: Byzantine – 100%.

Additional surveys: none.



88. The site Wadi Malih, view to the south-east from Wadi Malih plains, 1990. The figures are standing on top of the site (A. Zertal).



89. Pottery from Wadi Malih, all Iron I: 1. Jug base, brown; 2-5. CPs, dark gray.

CHAPTER FOUR

THE NARROW JORDAN VALLEY

LANDSCAPE UNIT 28



90. The Jordan, etching by van de Velde, 1862 (from *The Holy Land in Old Engravings and Illustrations* - Schiller 1977:196).

Site 36: 2015/19/12/1
FASS EJ-JAMAL

Israel grid: 2015/1926

UTM grid: 7396/5797

Elevation: 200 m b.s.l., 300 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: medium size

Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)

Topography: valley fringe

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: rendzina

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

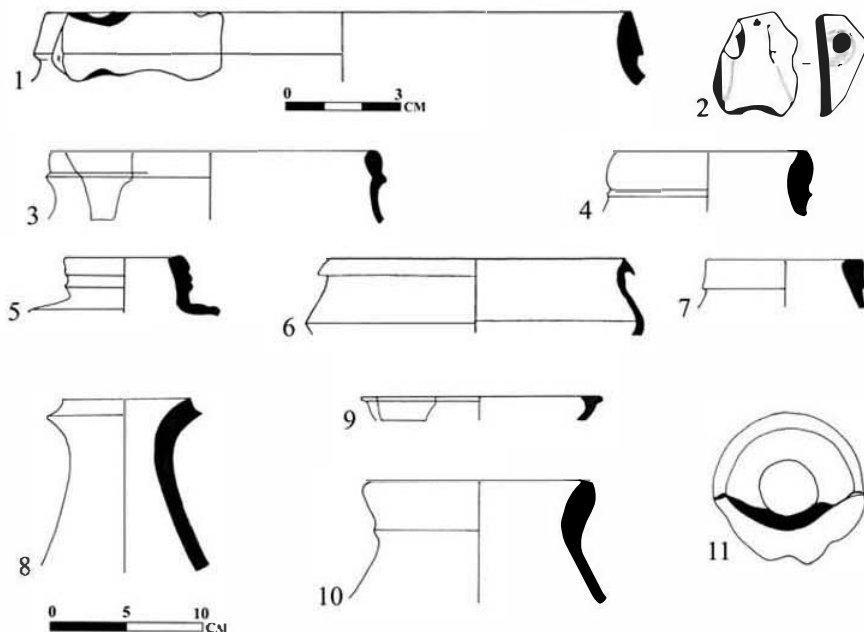
Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
 800 m distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
 500 m distant

Visit: Dec.1988; 62 sherds

This is a medium-sized site on a moderate slope in a valley fringe, looking east to the Jordan and the Eastern Jordan Valley. The location is about 1 km north-east of Brosh, and in the northern, lower, part of a high ridge near the lower terrace of the Jordan. Near it to the west passes the historical road along the Jordan Rift Valley.



91. Pottery from Fass ej-Jamal: 1, 6. CPs, dk brn, Ir I; 2. Lug handle, buff, Chal; 3. CP, brn, Ir II; 4. Jar, gr, Hel; 5. Jar, brn, Ir II; 7. Jar, brn, Ir I; 8. Jar, lt brn, ER; 9. Small bowl, cream, ER; 10. Jar, lt gr, Ir II; 11. Lid, brn, Byz.

In the site are the remains of a large stone structure, damaged by a tractor. Adjacent to it to the east is a courtyard measuring 25×20 m, surrounded by an earth dike. The structure and courtyard seem to have been from the Byz period, and the ancient settlement (mainly IA) spread over larger area.

Close to the site, to the south, are the remains of a small modern deserted village. Here were sighted foundations of ten dwelling units, including walls, *tabuns* (baking installations), barrels and large jars (*zir*) for water storage. About 200 m west of the complex is an isolated structure with Chalcolithic sherds.

Pottery: Chalcolithic – 9%; Iron I – 20%; Iron II – 7%; Hellenistic – 15%; Early Roman – 7%; Late Roman – 4%; Byzantine – 30%; Modern – 8%.

Stone: Chalcolithic basalt quern (Eitam 2005: 686).

Additional surveys: none.

Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 18.



Site 37: 20-19/01/2

HABS QATWI (2)

Israel grid: 2003/1915

UTM grid: 7384/5785

Elevation: 160 m b.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.

Name: ancient, but not on map

Site type: enclosure and pool

Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)

Topography: margin of inner valley

Rock type: Judea Group

Soil type: rendzina and silt

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
1.8 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
1 km distant

Visits: Nov. 1988; plan – May 2001; 70
sherds

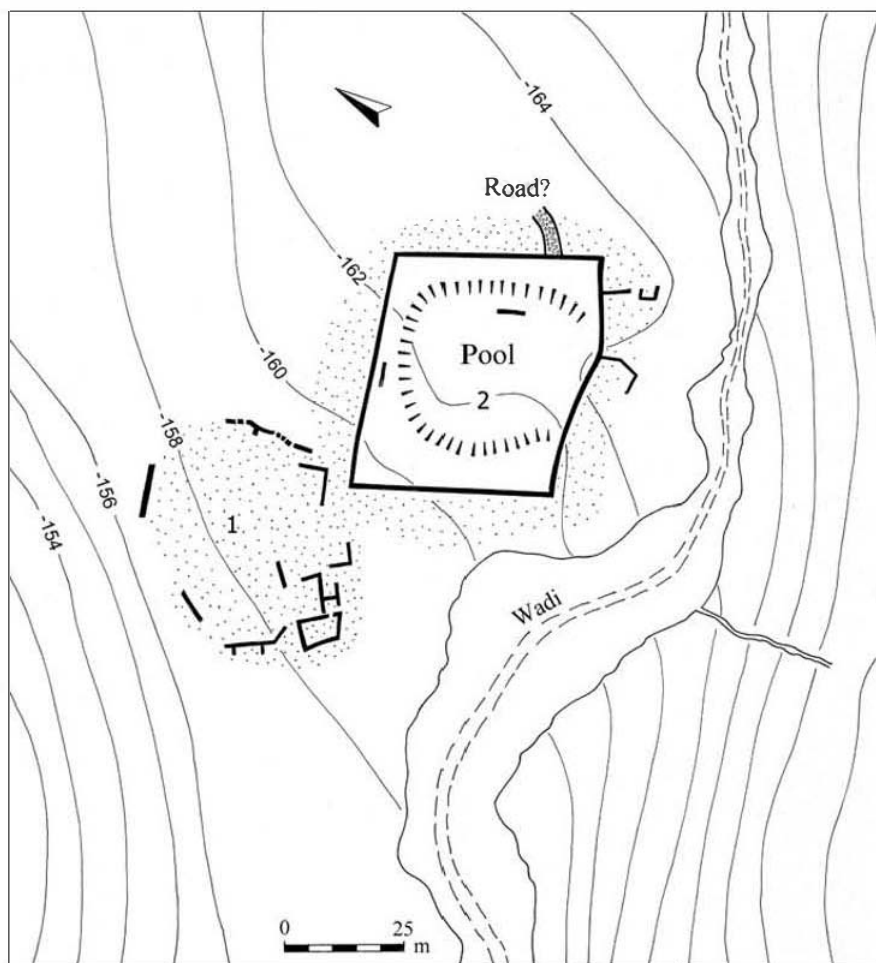
This is a large site in the western fringes of the small valley of Fass ej-Jamal. This valley is a topographical broadening between the ridges where Wadi el-Beiyadh ('the white') descends from the ridges of the area of 'Maale (ascent) Shay' into the Jordan Valley. The site is located 1 km west of Brosh and the Rift Valley road.

The site comprises two adjacent parts:

1. In the western part, between the riverbed and the steep rocky slope, were found the remains of a large oval-shaped enclosure (40×40 m). In the

northern part of the enclosure was found a well-built fieldstone wall, 60–100 cm thick. In the southern part are remains of structures built of field and cut stones. Their walls, which are built from two rows of stones, are 60–80 cm thick.

2. In the eastern part of the site were found the remains of a rectangular water reservoir, measuring 50×40 m. It is surrounded by an 80 cm thick well-built wall. Inside the surrounding wall is a large depression, whose lower part faces the wadi. The reservoir construction technique is similar to that of the reservoir in Kh. es-Suweideh (Zertal 2008: site 239). The reservoir was probably used for storing flood water from nearby Wadi el-Beiyadh. The wadi curves around the reservoir and it seems that the



92. Plan of Habs Qatwi (2), 2001.

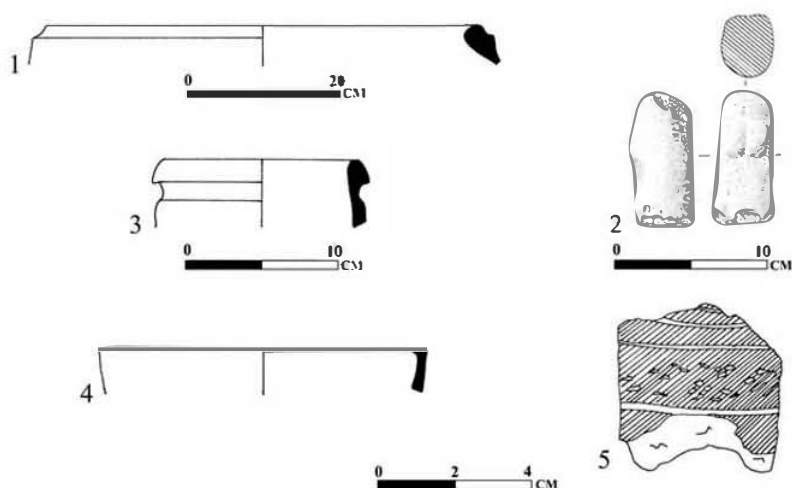
flood water was directed into it by a diversion channel. When the flood receded the reservoir remained full of water. Near the north-eastern wall of the courtyard is a built and paved road, 5 m wide, perhaps the approach road to the site.

This large settlement in the valley fringes was founded during IA II, but most of its habitation was in the Rom-Byz Period. It was a central settlement in the region, related to the vast grazing areas in it and to the Jericho–Beit She'an road. The water reservoir, identical to the reservoirs in Hadrian's' military array along the Jordan valley, identifies it as a Roman military camp: however, it is probable that it was meant for civilian use.

Pottery: Iron II – 10%; Late Roman-Byzantine – 65%; Middle Ages – 25%.

Stone: 4 basalt items (Eitam 2005: 686) and a possible basalt figurine (Fig. 93: 2).

Additional surveys: none.



93. Finds from Habs Qatwi (2): 1. CP, dk brn, Ir II; 2. Woman figurine (?), basalt; 3. Jar, cream, Byz; 4. Bowl, brn, LR; 5. Dec sherd, violet over cream, MA.

Site 38: 2●-19/●1/1

HABS QATWI (1)

Israel grid: 2●●8/1914

UTM grid: 7389/5785

Elevation: 18● m b.s.l., 5● m b.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: small farm

Area: 1 dunam (1●●● sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Judea Group

Soil type: silt and rendzina

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
1.7 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B1●),
5●● m distant

Visit: Nov. 1988; 12 sherds

This is a small site in the valley fringes of Fass ej-Jamal, close to the narrow road ascending from the Jordan Valley road to 'Maale Shay' and above the stream bed crossing the valley. It is about 6●● m south-west of Brosh.

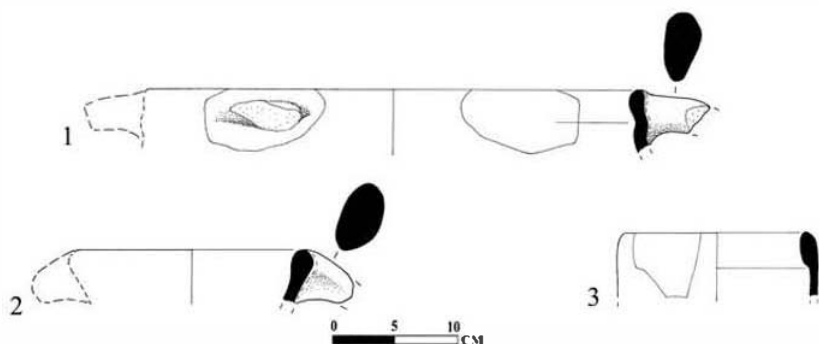
The remains of two or three rectangular structures were located, built of fieldstones. The walls are about 6● cm thick, with large stones at the corners. A very small sherd scatter was collected.

It seems that this was a farm on the edge of the valley, with grazing and scanty agriculture.

Pottery: Iron II – 64%; Late Roman – 27%; Byzantine – 9%.

Flint: 2 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



94. Pottery from Habs Qatwi (1): 1. Bowl, lt brn, Ir II; 2. Jar, lt brn, Ir II; 3. Jar, buff, Byz.

Site 38 (1): 20-18/28/1

KHIRBET SHEIKH FALIKH

Israel grid: 2029/1884

UTM grid: 7410/5755

Elevation: 310 m b.s.l., 0 m b.s.a.

Name: ancient and on map

Site type: small

Topography: plain

Cultivation: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
500 m distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
1 km distant

Visit: not visited due to minefields

This is a small site, located about 3.8 km south-south-east of Brosh.

Mellaart visited (Mellaart 1962: site 73) and described: "Fragments of coarse stone foundations denuded. Roman and Byzantine coarse ware pottery."

The site is situated in an area of minefields, and therefore was not visited.

Pottery (in Mellaart's survey): Roman; Byzantine.

Additional surveys: Mellaart 1962: site 73.



Site 39: 20-18/26/1

EL-'ARQUB

Israel grid: 2021/1865

UTM grid: 7403/5736

Elevation: 210 m b.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: flint scatter

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judea Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
700 m distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
next to the site

Visit: Dec. 1988

This is a site on a steep slope descending from the west to the Jordan Valley, about 5 km south of Brosh.

Over the slope is an abundant scatter of flints, which includes cores, globular items, blades and scrapers, indicating a workshop or flint production. No items were collected.

Flint: Middle Palaeolithic and Epipalaeolithic.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 4●: 2●-18/25/1

KHIRBET EJ-JUNEIDIYEH

Israel grid: 2●28/1854

UTM grid: 741●/5725

Elevation: 31● m b.s.l., ● m a.s.a.

Name: ancient and on map

Site type: medium size

Area: 5 dunams (5●●● sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: marl

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: unknown

Water source: 'Ein Juneidiyeh (18●),
4●● m distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B1●),
5●● m distant

Visit: June 2●●2; 3● sherds

This is a medium-sized site on a slope facing the lower Jordan terrace on the eastern side of the security fence.

Mellaart (1962: site 74), who surveyed it, writes: "Fragments of a course of a



95. The site at Kh. ej-Juneidiyeh and a view of the Zor, 2002 (M. Einav).

stone foundation denuded. Periods of occupation: Roman Byzantine, coarse ware." According to Gophna and Porath (1972: site 137), visiting the place in 1967: "The ruin is totally cleared of stones and cultivated. Stone heaps are scattered in the area. A fragment of a monolithic limestone pillar was found, and many mosaic stones and fragments of a few roof tiles. Pottery find: Byzantine period."

The site does not appear in the British Survey, nor in Glueck's map.

While visiting the site remains of a few structures were found and the monolithic column was sighted next to a trench in a minefield. Close to the riverbed descending to the *Zor* was a circular structure, about 6 m in diameter, made of stone and plastered. We did not investigate the entire site because most of it is mined.

It seems that the ruins lie in the *Zor* plain on both sides of the riverbed.

Pottery: Late Roman – 50%; Byzantine – 50%.

Additional surveys: Mellaart 1962: site 74; Gophna and Porath 1972: site 137.



Site 41: 20-18/34/1

KHIRBET WADI SADD EL-BALQAWI

Israel grid: 2030/1840

UTM grid: 7413/5711

Elevation: 290 m b.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 4 dunams (4000 sq. m)

Topography: spur

Rock type: Lisan marl

Soil type: marl

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

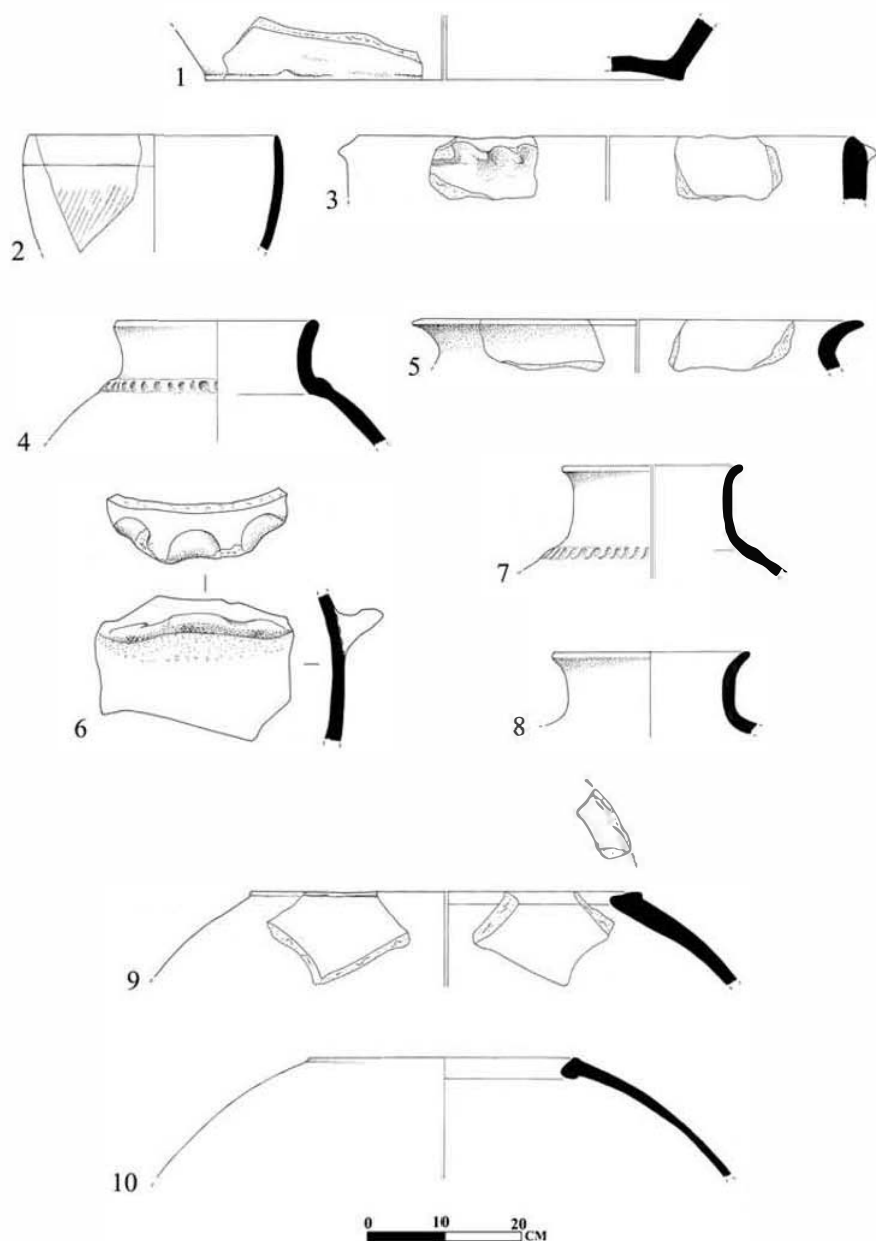
Water source: River Jordan (112),
300 m distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
600 m distant

Visit: June 2002; 50 sherds

This is a small site on a high spur in the *Zor* plateau, about 30 m above the low plain of the *Zor*. The site is cut in two by the Wadi Sadd el-Balqawi riverbed, descending from the south-west. From the site is a good view to the lower Jordan terrace, and nowadays an unpaved road along the *Zor* crosses it.

Only the southern side of the site was checked, but it seems that it also extends to the northern side, which cannot be investigated due to the risk of mines.



96. Pottery from Khirbet Wadi Sadd el Balqawi, all IB, buff, well fired: 1. Base; 2. Bowl, combed incised dec; 3. Krater, rope dec; 4, 7. Jars, rope dec; 5, 8. Jars; 6. Folded ledge handle; 9-10. HM.

On the flat spur, isolated on the south and east by a steep slope descending to the *Zor*, and in the north by the steep wadi riverbed, were found remains of a few walls 50–60 cm thick. The site's houses have been cut by the slopes and the wadi. Large and medium building stones, also found north of the wadi channel, are evidence of construction in that area.

An abundance of pottery is scattered over the spur, containing especially large fragments of various vessels. It is clear that the place has not been investigated, which explains the great number of indicative sherds. It seems that several houses stood in the place, but no fortification was found.

Pottery: Intermediate Bronze – 100%.

Flint: 4 items, Intermediate Bronze, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 42: 20-17/19/1

KHIRBET EDH-DHRA

Israel grid: 2018/1793

UTM grid: 7401/5663

Elevation: 265 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: valley

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: marl and brown forest

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Saleh (170),

600 m distant

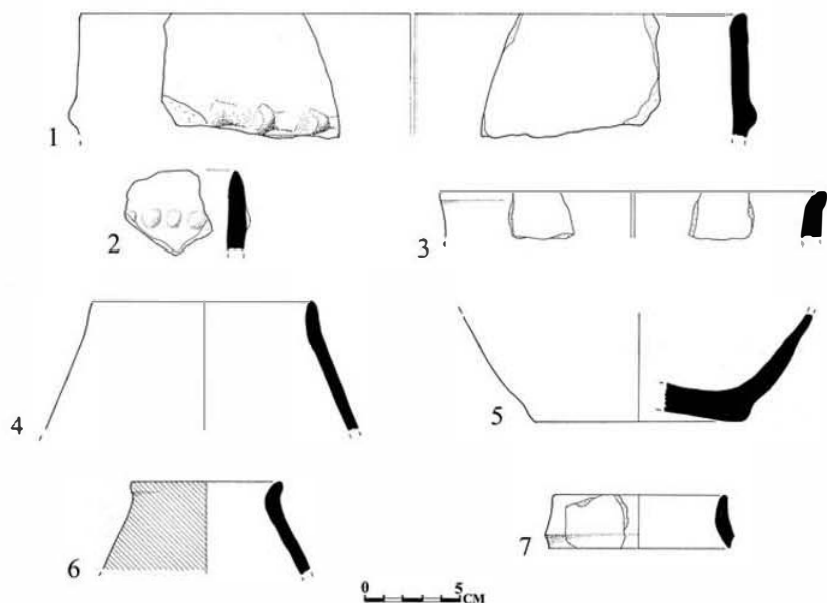
Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),

next to the site

Visit: Jan. 1989; 60 sherds

This is a small site on a narrow spur in an inner valley in the Jordan Valley, close to the west of the Beit She'an–Jericho road, and about 3.5 km north of Argaman.

The valley, formed by the broadening of Wadi Mudaraj, is partly cultivated. About 600 m north of the wadi is Khirbet el-Gharur (Zertal 2008: site 259). The valley is cut by channels 20–25 m deep, making it difficult to approach the spurs among them. On the spur between two such channels were found a large pottery scatter and a flint and groundstone tool assemblage (Bar 2014a: 512). There was no indication of architecture.



97. Pottery from Khirbet edh-Dhra, all Chal: 1. Basin, buff, rope dec; 2. Rope dec, lt brn; 3. Bowl, buff; 4. Jar, buff; 5. Base, cream; 6. Amphoriskos, rd slip, buff; 7. Amphoriskos, buff.

Pottery: Chalcolithic – 100%.

Additional surveys: none

Additional Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 45.



Site 43: 2017/09/1

EL-MUDARAJ (1)

Israel grid: 2009/1792

UTM grid: 7392/5662

Elevation: 100 m b.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 3 dunams (3000 sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Saleh (170),
1 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
500 m distant

Visit: Jan. 1989; 34 sherds

This is a site on an eastern slope of E.P. -7, in the northern margins of the small valley of Wadi el-Mudaraj, which is situated west of the Jordan Valley road, about 3.5 km north of Argaman.

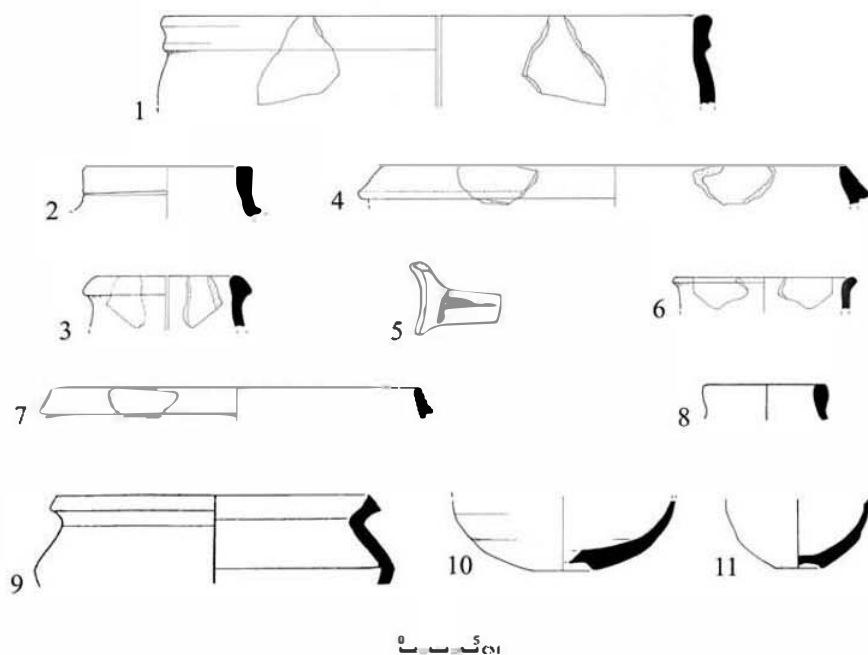
The site has a stone dike enclosing an area 30×30 m leading to a standing rock 8 m high. The dike is built of large and small stones, covered with earth, and stands 2 m high above the slope. The upper part of the dike is covered with organic matter, and sherds were found on it. There are also walls *in situ* on the step south of the site.

This is a small settlement, with Early IA pottery and a few IA II and Byz sherds.

Pottery: Iron I – 80%; Iron II – 10%; Byzantine – 10%.

Flint: 4 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



98. Pottery from el-Mudaraj (1): 1. CP, brn, Ir I; 2-3, 6. Jars and jugs, lt brn, Byz; 4, 7. CPs, dk brn, Ir I; 8. Jug, buff, Byz; 9. CP A, dk brn, Ir I; 10-11. Bases, gr, Ir II.

Site 44: 20-17/29/1

KHIRBET ES-SALEH

Israel grid: 2021/1790	Soil quality: 3
UTM grid: 7405/5661	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 280 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: ancient and on map	Water source: 'Ein Saleh (170), at the site
Site type: medium size	Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10), next to the site
Area: 4 dunams (4000 sq. m)	Visit: not visited due to minefields
Topography: carved plain	
Rock type: Dead Sea Group	
Soil type: Lisan marl	

This is a medium-sized site on the *Ghor* carved hills, descending to the low terrace of the Jordan Valley, close to the east side of the Jordan Valley road, and about 4.5 km north-north-east of Argaman.

Glueck (1951: 420) visited the site in 1943 and his description is: "Khirbet es-Salih (256), at the very edge of the *Ghor*, is overlooking the beginning of the qattarah hills which lead down to the small *Zor* Abu Sidreh. It is on the E side of the modern N-S *Ghor* road. The *Ghor* in this area is quite narrow and unimportant compared to the *Ghor* on the E side of the Jordan, in which a whole group of important tulul is located, the most imposing one of them being Tell Deir 'Alla. The small Wadi es-Salih passes below the N side of Khirbet es-Salih and leads down E-S-E to join the Jordan near the N limit of the *Zor* Abu Sidreh. There is a small spring in the wadi below Khirbet es-Salih. This site is bounded also on the S side by a small gully. There is no mound as such visible at Khirbet es-Salih, whose presence is betrayed by some foundation-walls and by the presence of considerable numbers of sherds, which belong in the main to Iron Age I-II. There were also numerous Roman and Byzantine sherds. These various types of sherds were found also on the W side of the modern road. About 70 m to the W of the modern road, and more or less parallel with it, are some paved sections of the Roman road, which once extended from Scythopolis (Beisan) to Jericho. The 6 m wide Roman road was divided into two by a raised curb down the center. Khirbet es-Salih is marked by some modern graves."

Gophna and Porath (1972: site 170) describe it thus: "A ruin on three hill-tops in the *Ghor* area; about 4 dunams in area. Foundations of structures from exposed fieldstones over the surface. Pottery find: from the Late Canaanite II and Israelite I periods."

In the British Survey map, roughly in this place, is a site called Kubur ed Delameh, but its description does not appear in the text of Sheet XII of the map.

The site is situated in an area of modern minefields, and therefore was not visited.

Pottery (summary of the different surveys): Late Bronze; Iron I-II; Early and Late Roman; Byzantine.

Additional surveys: Glueck 1951: site 256; Gophna and Porath 1972: site 170.



Site 45: 20-17/28/1

TELL ABU SIDREH

Israel grid: 2026/1784

UTM grid: 7410/5655

Elevation: 310 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name: ancient and on map

Site type: tell

Area: about 10 dunams (1 ha),
estimate from a distance.

Topography: low hills

Rock type: Dead Sea Group

Soil type: Lisan marl

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: not known

Water source: River Jordan (112),
800 m distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
1.2 km distant

Visit: not visited due to minefields

Tell in the eastern edge of the *Ghor*, where it merges with the *Zor*, about 4 km north-east of Argaman.

The British Survey (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 246) says: "Tell Abu Sidreh... An artificial mound, now occupied by an Arab graveyard."

Glueck (1951: 419-420) visited the site in June 1943 and described it thus: "Tell Abu Sidreh (255), is located in the *Zor* proper, below the qattarah hills which separate the *Zor* from the higher *Ghor* level of the Jordan Valley. It is a small mound, whose steepest sides are on the N and E, and it overlooks from the N the confluence of the small, dry Wadi Abu Sidreh with the River Jordan... The level stretch of the *Zor* of Tell Abu Sidreh was anciently cultivated at the time of our visit to the tel by some Arab families, living in a small encampment of five black tents. Tell Abu Sidreh commands access to the ford leading across the river. Called Mukhadet Abu Sidreh now, it controls thus the track leading to a group of important tels in a wide expanse of the *Ghor* on the E side of the



99. Tell Abu Sidreh, view to the east, 2002 (M. Einav).

Jordan... In addition to numerous Roman and Byzantine and some mediaeval Arabic sherds, a considerable number of Iron Age I-II sherds was found on and immediately around Tell Abu Sidreh. A short distance to the N-W of this tel, are the ruins of a small, Roman-Byzantine site, whose foundations are flush with the ground. Numerous Roman-Byzantine sherds were found among the ruins. In all of these periods of occupation, the small **Zor** Abu Sidreh may have afforded a convenient halting place for caravans to and from the E side of the Jordan."

On May 2002, the Manasseh Hill Country Survey team travelled along the **Zor** road, about 200 m west of the site. The tell and the area around it are in a minefield and it was impossible to visit the site, but the observation yielded the following impressions: This is an isolated natural hill, with the tell on it, situated in the centre of the **Zor** plain. Nearby and south of the site passes the channel of Wadi Abu Sidreh. The long axis of the tell is west to east; in the north and south are steep slopes. The Roman-Byzantine ruin mentioned by Glueck was also identified close to the unpaved road we travelled.

Pottery (by Glueck): Iron I-II; Early and Late Roman; Byzantine; Middle Ages.
Additional surveys: Glueck 1951: site 255.

Site 46: 20-17/08/1

EL-MUKEIMNAT

Israel grid: 2001/1782	Soil quality: 4
UTM grid: 7384/5653	Cultivation: field crops and not cultivated
Elevation: 205 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: nearest place	Water source: 'Ein Saleh (170), 2.2 km distant
Site type: courtyard	Road: Beit She'an-Jericho (B10), 1.4 km distant
Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)	Visits: Jan. 1990, Oct. 2003; 21 sherds
Topography: valley margins	
Rock type: Avdat Group	
Soil type: rendzina	

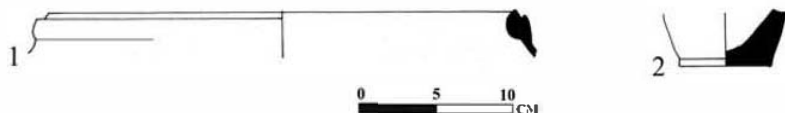
This is a small site in the margins of an inner small valley, one of the many valleys in the contact zone between the ridge west of the Jordan Valley and the valley itself. This valley is close to the wide Wadi Abu Sidreh, and the site location is about 2.4 km north of Argaman.

In the site is a rectangular courtyard built of particularly large stones, of which two parallel walls remain, each about 25 m long; the perpendicular walls are missing. The number of sherds is small, and many building stones are scattered in the nearby field and in the site's vicinity.

This site belongs to the 'courtyards' series, of which dozens have been discovered by the Manasseh Hill Country Survey. In most cases, like this one, the site was founded in the IA and was in use in its present form in the Byz period.

Pottery: Iron II – 50%; Byzantine – 50%.

Additional surveys: none.



100. Pottery from el-Mukeimnat: 1. CP, dk brn, Ir II; 2. Jug base, gr, Byz.

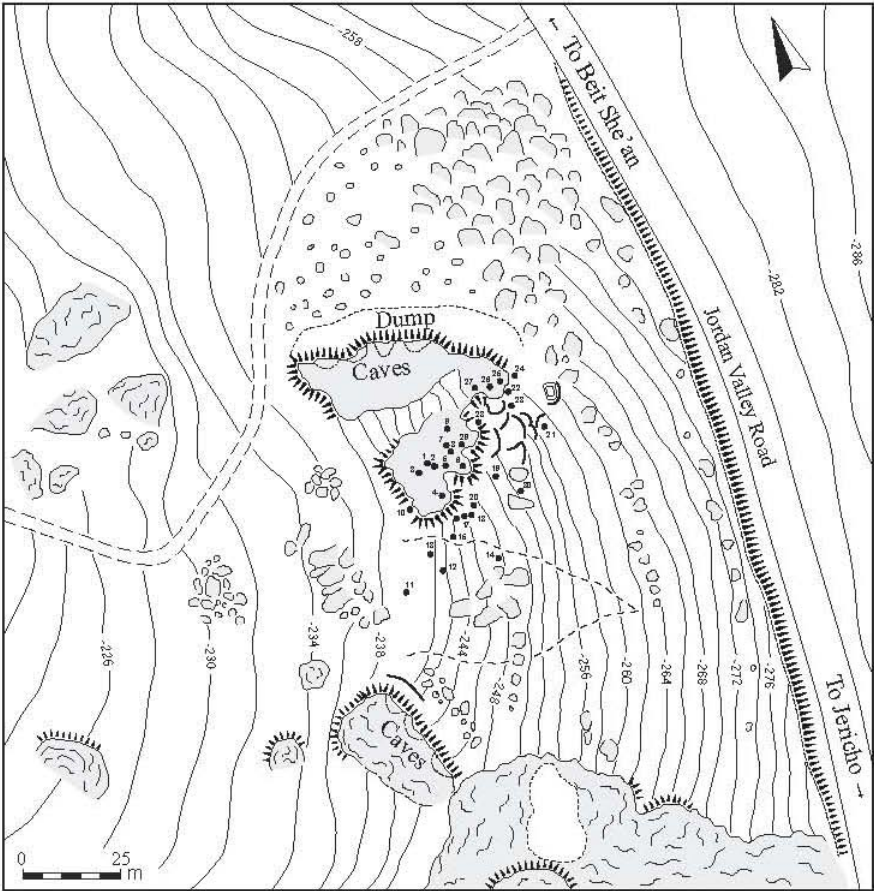
Site 47: 20-17/18/1
HUZUQ MUSA

Israel grid: 2014/1782	Soil quality: 2
UTM grid: 7398/5653	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 260 m b.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: ancient but not on map	Water source: 'Ein Saleh (170), 1.2 km distant
Site type: prehistoric, caves	Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10), next to the site
Area: 20 dunams (2 ha)	Visits: 1988, 2000, 2004 and many more; 125 sherds
Topography: spur edge on a rocky plateau	
Rock type: conglomerate Avdat	
Soil type: stony-desert	

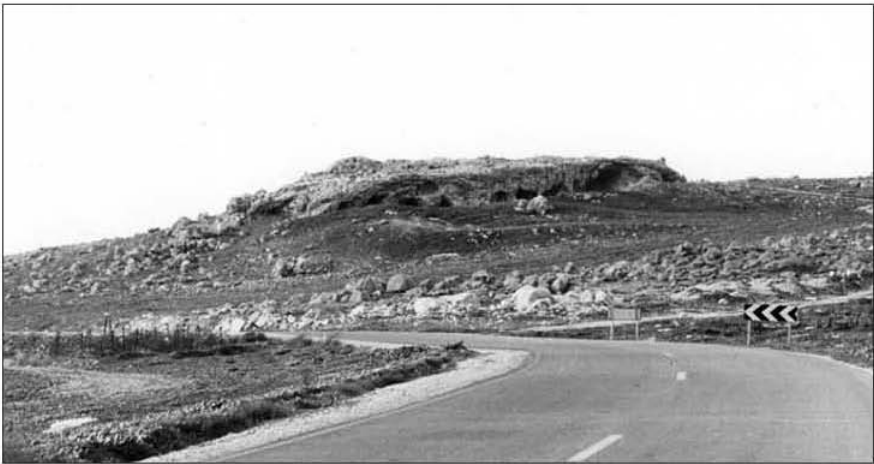
This is a site of prehistoric remains, caves and installations, west of the Beit She'an–Jericho road, about 3 km north-north-west of Argaman.

The site has three main parts:

1. Two clusters of shallow caves in low cliffs. One cluster is in a cliff looking north to the road, and the other cluster is within inner cliffs, about 100 m south of the first one. The cave ceilings are relatively low, and they are only about 3 m deep. It is clear that the ceilings of all the caves have collapsed and large rocks from them are strewn in front of the entrances. The caves served as shelters for flocks (the ceilings are blackened by smoke), and in the debris in front of them are strewn sherds of various periods.
2. There are about 50 narrow and deep rock-cut basins, scattered over about a 10 dunam (1 ha) area. The basins are arranged in two groups: one of about 20 basins is in the upper part of the cliff which is above the first (northern) cluster of caves. The second group, of about 30 basins, is arranged in a sort of natural theatre among the rocks, south of the first one. Most of the basins are cut in small rock crevices appearing here and there, spaced about 2 to 4 m from each other. The upper diameter of most of the basins is about 20 cm, and the depth is 50–60 cm on average. They are conical, and show signs of grinding and smoothing (see Eitam 2005: 686–689; 2008; 2010).
3. The slope in front of the southern caves slopes eastward down to the road. It is covered by considerable quantities of silt, and parts of it are supported by built terraces. In its northern part are remains of several round structures, 3–4 m in diameter. Many flint items are strewn over the entire area (see Appendix A).



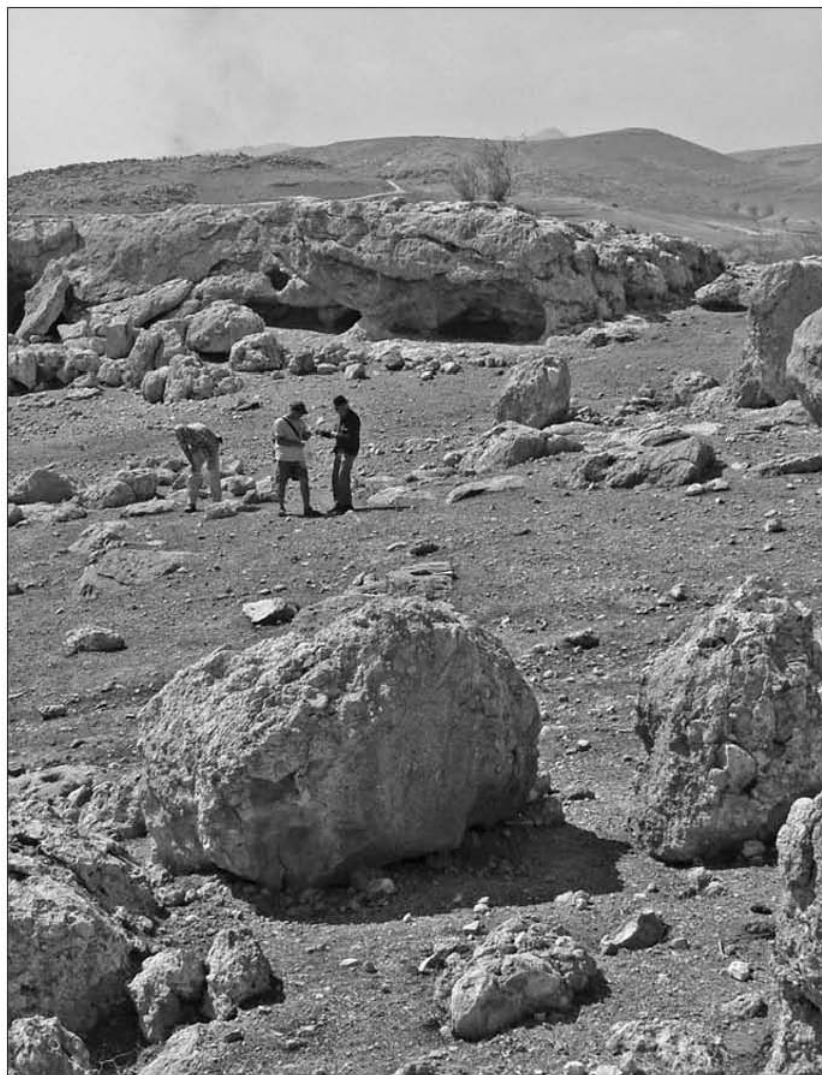
101. Plan of Huzuq Musa, 2005. The rock-cut installations are marked as black dots.



102. Huzuq Musa, view to the south, 1987. Note the low cliff and the caves (A. Zertal).

4. In the slope by the southern caves were found beads, sherds and pendants belonging to the LB I period (15th century BCE). The origin of these objects is possibly from burials in the caves. Some sherds and jewellery belong to later burials, dated to the IA II. After the collapse of the ceilings the remains were washed down the slope (see Be'eri and Cohen 2008).

In the 2008 trial excavation (Rosenberg et al. 2010) the remains of two adjacent structures with a small enclosure between them were unearthed. The main structure is 3 m long, oval in shape, and opens to the south. Its walls, built of



103. The southern rock shelter at Huzuq Musa, view to the west, 2005 (M. Einav).

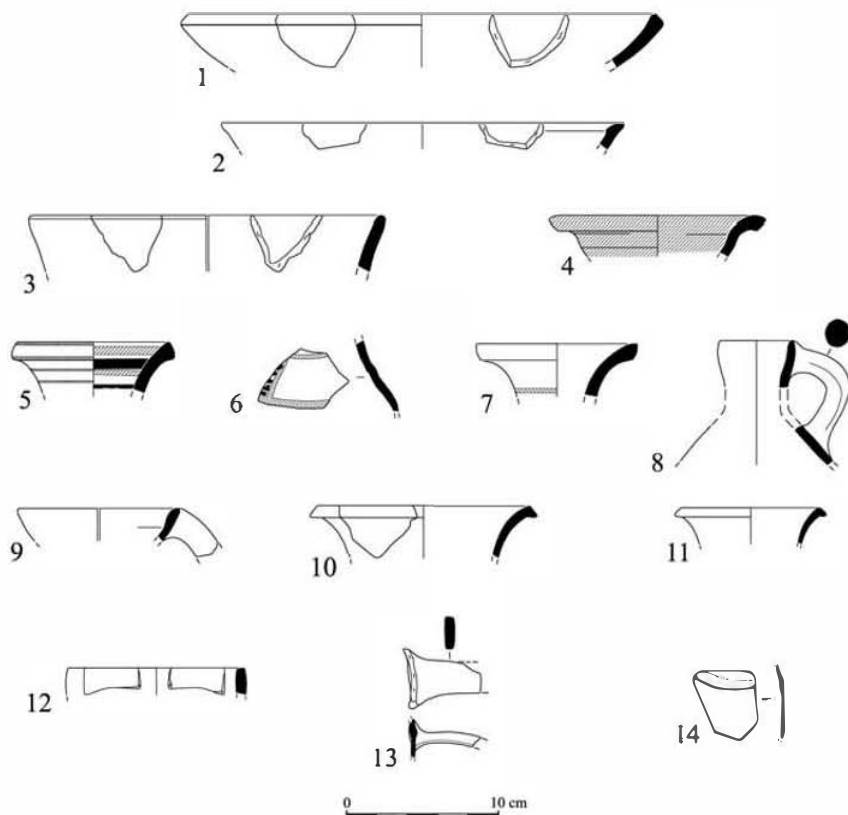
fieldstones of varying sizes, survived to four courses high (80 cm). A very rich flint assemblage was retrieved, and additional finds include many stone and shell beads, okra remains, two upper grinding stones and a few animal bones (mainly of mountain gazelle - *Gazella gazella*). These finds were dated by the excavators to a transitional phase between the Epipalaeolithic and the Early Neolithic periods.

Pottery: Late Bronze I – 30%; Iron II – 10%; Byzantine – 10%; Middle Ages – 20%; Modern – 30%.

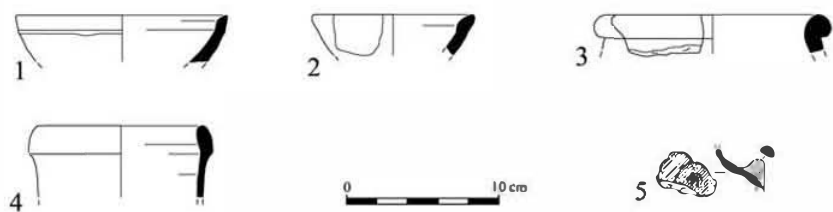
Flint: 2227 items, Epipalaeolithic (final stage), see Appendix A.

Stone: 12 items, Epipalaeolithic, Iron Age and Modern (see Eitam 2005: 686-689).

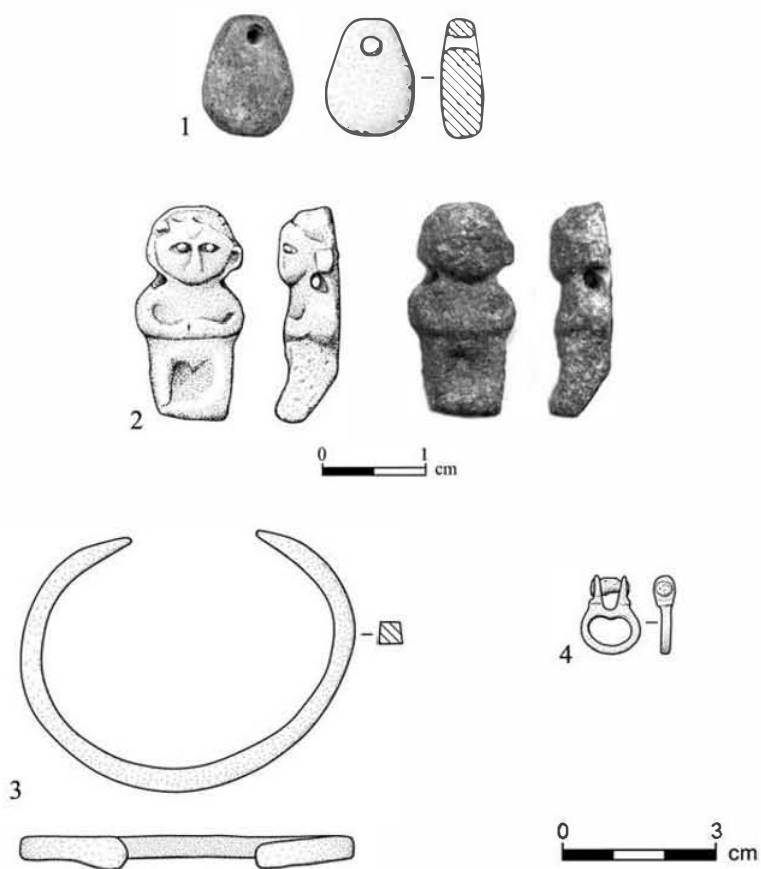
Additional surveys: none.



104. Late Bronze Age I pottery from Huzuq Musa: 1-3. Bowls, brn; 4. Jar, lt, rd slip; 5-6. Jars, lt, rd and blk dec; 7. Juglet, lt, blk dec; 8-9. Dipper juglets, lt; 10-12. Juglets (Cypriot Monochrome Ware), lt-brn slip; 13-14. Juglets (Cypriot Base Ring I Ware), dk-brn slip.



105. Iron Age II pottery from Huzuq Musa: 1-2. Bowls, reddish; 3. Jar, reddish-brn; 4. Jug, gr; 5. Pyxis, reddish-brn, rd slip.



106. Pendants, a bracelet and an earring from the burials at Huzuq Musa.

Site 48: 20-17/07/1

EN-NA'AJEH (2)

Israel grid: 2004/1773

UTM grid: 7388/5644

Elevation: 240 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: cave and enclosure

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: saddle

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
2.5 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
1 km distant

Visit: Nov. 1989; 40 sherds

This site is a cave, enclosure and an upright rocky cliff in the en-Na'a'jeh plateau, in the inner part of the broad Wadi Abu Sidreh, about 1.3 km north-north-east of Argaman.

The site is in the northern side of a cultivated saddle. There is a curved wall of large boulders, about 40 m long, starting at the upright cliff above the cave entrance and reaching back to it, creating a courtyard. East of the courtyard are additional walls, perhaps belonging to dismantled structures.

This is an encampment site and shepherd's pen-cave, having been in use for a long period. Such sites are quite numerous at the edge of the desert.



107. The site of en-Na'a'jeh (2), view to the west, 1989 (A. Zertal).

Pottery: Iron I – 40%; Late Roman – 60%.

Flint: 2 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 49: 20-17/07/2

EN-NA'AJEH (3)

Israel grid: 2003/1772

UTM grid: 7388/5642

Elevation: 240 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: cave and courtyard

Area: 0.6 dunam (600 sq. m)

Topography: saddle

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
2.2 km distant

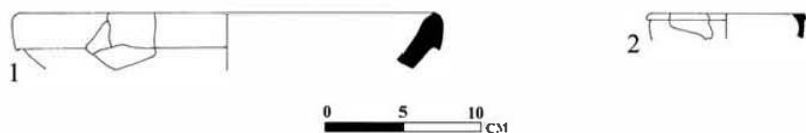
Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
1 km distant

Visit: Nov. 1989; 13 sherds

This is a site of caves, cliffs and a courtyard in the saddle west of en-Na'ajeh, about 1.3 km north-north-east of Argaman.



108. The site at en-Na'ajeh (3), view to the north, 1989. The courtyard was formed by connecting walls to the cliffs at west and east (A. Zertal).



109. Pottery from en-Na'ajeh (3): 1. Bowl, buff, Pers; 2. Bowl, lt brn, LR.

Sherds were found in a large triangular courtyard, built between two lines of cliffs. The gaps between the northern and southern cliffs were blocked by stone walls, on which a modern fence has been erected. Thus, a flock-pen has been created, being used by the neighbouring inhabitants.

The site belongs to the 'cave sites', abundant in a narrow strip of the Jordan Valley.

Pottery: Iron II – 80%; Persian – 10%; Late Roman – 10%.

Flint: 5 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 50: 20-17/06/1

EN-NA'AJEH (6)

Israel grid: 2006/1763

UTM grid: 7390/5633

Elevation: 240 m b.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: cave

Area: 1.5 dunams (1500 sq. m)

Topography: cliff and slope

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: alluvium

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
1.7 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
200 m distant

Visit: Jan. 1990; 43 sherds

This is a small cave site in a small valley, roughly 1 km north-north-east of Zbeidat.

The site is a part of low and broken bluff, 8 to 10 m high, one of the conglomerate rock arrays on the west side of the Jordan Valley. There are three caves of different heights and area. They are as follows:

1. Two caves in the rear part of the cliff. The opening of the larger one is at ground level and a shallower cave is above it. The large cave is about 20 m

deep, with a ceiling about 2 m high. In front of both those caves openings are several walls.

2. The opening of the third cave is about 20 m west of the other caves. This cave is partially blocked by a stone wall.

In front of the caves is a semicircular terrace wall built of large stones. This wall formed a pen 1 dunam (1000 sq. m) in area. In this pen the herds were kept and the cave served as dwelling. Fragments of sherds (mainly tiny) were found in the litter in front of the caves.

Pottery: Iron II – 30%; Byzantine – 60%; Middle Ages – 10%.

Additional surveys: none.



110. The site of en-Na'a'jeh (6), view to the north, 1990 (S. Hashman).

Site 51: 20-17/06/2

EN-NA'AJEH (4)

Israel grid: 2008/1763	Soil quality: 2
UTM grid: 7392/5633	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 236 m b.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: nearest place	Water source: River Jordan (112), 1.5 km distant
Site type: caves	Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10), next to the site
Area: 3 dunams (3000 sq. m)	Visits: Nov. 1989, May 2002; 70 sherds
Topography: valley margins	
Rock type: Avdat Group	
Soil type: stony-desert	

This is a cave site in the margins of the Jordan Valley, close to the Beit She'an–Jericho road south of en-Na'ajeh village, about 1.3 km north-east of Argaman.

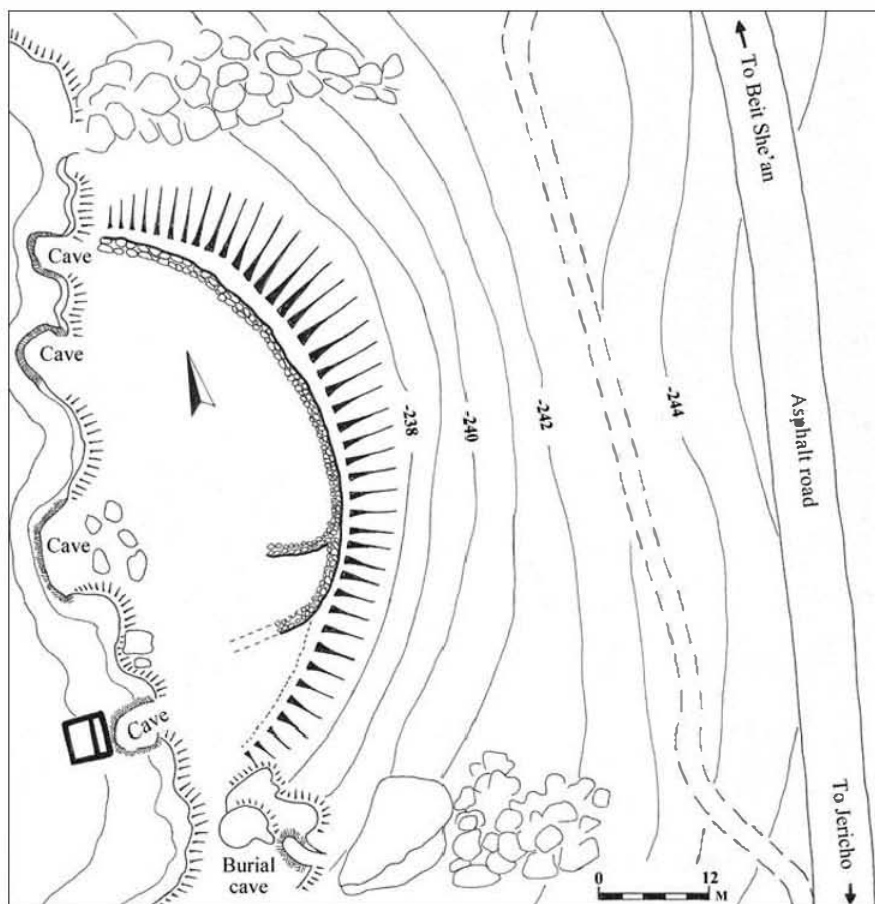
The site is situated in a fractured cliff on a plateau west of the Jordan Valley road. The cliff is about 12 m high, and contains many cave openings. Most of these lead into shallow caves, but the two middle ones are large and deep. Their openings are tall arches about 3 m high. The large caves are about 6 m deep with openings 5 to 8 m wide.

In front of these caves is a courtyard built of large stones, adjacent to the cliff and forming a pen. It is 45 m in diameter, and is partitioned inside. On the cliff above the caves is a small structure, its date unclear. At the southern side of the complex is a deep narrow cave, which possibly served as a burial cave. Various LB and IA body sherds were found in the debris in front. In the slope descending eastward to the road are more construction remains: perhaps structures stood here, but are now difficult to reconstruct.

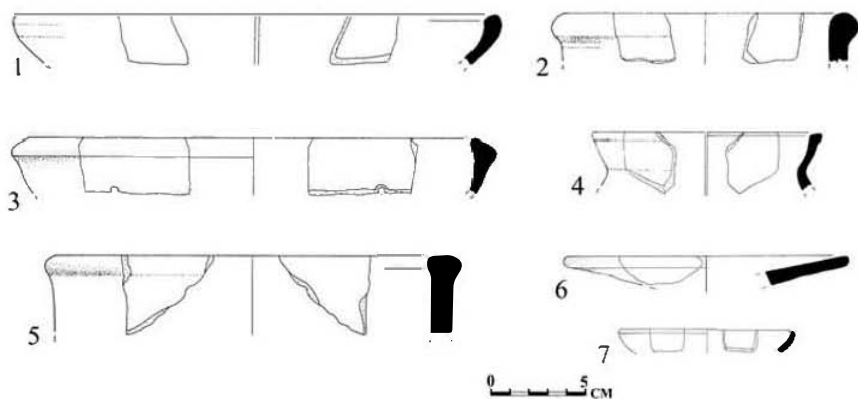
Pottery, in the site: Iron II – 30%; Late Roman – 10%; Byzantine – 10%; Middle Ages – 50%. In the burial cave: Late Bronze – 50%; Iron II – 50%.

Flint: 3 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.



111. Plan of en-Na'a'jeh (4), 2001.



112. Pottery from en-Na'a'jeh (4): 1. Bowl, lt brn, Ir II; 2. Jar, brn, Ir II; 3. Bowl, cream, LR; 4. Jar, brn, LR; 5. Bowl, dk brn, Ir II; 6. Platter, buff, Rom; 7. Bowl, buff, Rom.



113. The site of en-Na'a'jeh (4), view to the north-west, 1989 (A. Zertal).



Site 52: 20-17/06/3

EN-NA'AJEH (5)

Israel grid: 2009/1765

UTM grid: 7393/5635

Elevation: 270 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: courtyard

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: valley

Rock type: Lisan Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
1.5 km distant

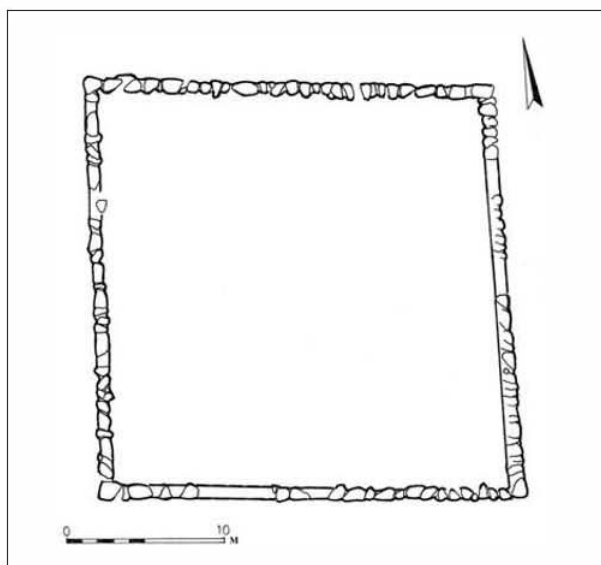
Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
next to the site

Visit: Jan. 1990; 38 sherds

A courtyard built of large stones, close to the eastern side of the Jordan Valley road, 1.8 km north-east of Argaman. It is south of en-Na'a'jeh village, within its agricultural plots, in the floodplain of the Jordan Valley.

The squareish courtyard 28×28 m is built of a single row of very large stones, measuring 100×60 cm on average. They are laid in a straight line and the average wall width is 70 cm.

North of the site is the modern cemetery of en-Na'a'jeh village.



114. Plan of en-Na'a'jeh (5), 1990.

On April 187● Guérin (1969: 266) passed through the area, noting: “At 7:45 I saw a square enclosure built of fairly large stones, The length of each of its sides is about one hundred paces, and I have been told that its name is Khirbet ‘Asira.” This probably referred to the above site.

Pottery: Late Roman – 84%; Middle Ages – 16%.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 53: 19-17/96/2

WADI UMM KHUBEZA (2)

Israel grid: 1993/1766

UTM grid: 7377/5637

Elevation: 17● m b.s.l., 3● m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: shoulder

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

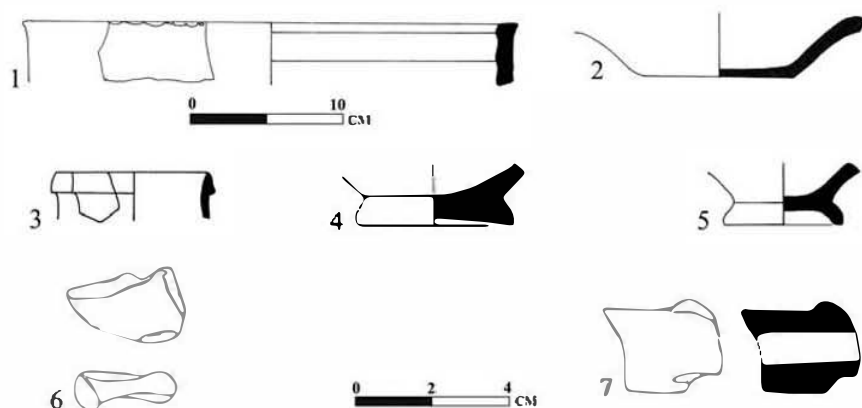
Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
3 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B1●),
1.5 km distant

Visit: March 1989; 62 sherds



115. Pottery from Wadi Umm Khubeza (2): 1. Basin, gr, finger impression on rim, EM; 2. Bowl base, brn, LR; 3. Jar, pk, Rom; 4-5. Jug bases, lt brn, Ir II; 6. 'Pan' handle, lt brn, Byz; 7. Spout, brn, Ir II.

This is a small site in the inner valley of Wadi Abu Sidreh, about 1 km north of Argaman.

The site covers a wide shoulder north of the small valley. The shoulder is surrounded by fairly deep ravines, and has links to its vicinity only to the north-west. Scattered stones and sherds were found here without construction remains. The stones form structures, and it seems that there were tents or bivouacs on the shoulder.

Tents and bivouacs have been especially numerous in Wadi Abu Sidreh throughout the ages.

Pottery: Iron II – 20%; Late Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 20%; Early Moslem – 20%; Middle Ages – 20%.

Additional surveys: none.

Site 54: 19-17/96/1

WADI UMM KHUBEZA (3)

Israel grid: 1995/1765	Soil quality: 4
UTM grid: 7375/5654	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 190 m b.s.l., 40 m b.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: nearest place	Water source: River Jordan (112), 2.8 km distant
Site type: encampment	Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10), 1.2 km distant
Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)	Visit: Jan. 1990; 35 sherds
Topography: spur and ravine	
Rock type: Avdat Group	
Soil type: stony-desert	

This is a small site in the channel of Wadi Umm Khubeza, one of the streams in the upper part of Wadi Abu Sidreh. In this place the wadi broadens to become a small valley, containing a number of tents and bivouac sites.

The site is located on a shoulder descending from the north-west into the wadi channel, which is about 3 m deep. This channel hampers the approach to the site. Over the shoulder are a few remains of foundations of crude structures and a number of sherds. In a cross-section of the riverbed layers containing ashes and sherds are being revealed, testifying to encampments of many periods.

Pottery: Iron II – 30%, Byzantine – 50%; Early Moslem – 20%.

Additional surveys: none.

Site 55: 19-17/96/3

WADI UMM KHUBEZA (1)

Israel grid: 199●/1766

UTM grid: 7374/5636

Elevation: 17● m b.s.l., ● m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 2 dunams (2●●● sq. m)

Topography: shoulder

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
3.5 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B1●),
2 km distant

Visit: March 1989; 67 sherds

This is a small site on a shoulder in the widening valley of Wadi Umm Khubeza, which is the upper channel of Wadi Abu Sidreh, about 1 km north-north-west of Argaman.

The site is in an enclosed small valley, over a flat shoulder surrounded by deep ravines. These ravines isolate the shoulder almost completely from its surroundings, and the approach to it is possible only from the west. On the shoulder is an enclosing wall, and next to it are the remains of structures or rooms.



116. The site of Wadi Umm Khubeza (1), view to the north-east, 1990.

The site was destroyed by heavy equipment, and only scattered building stones and sherds have been left. This makes the understanding of the original plan of the site difficult.

Pottery: Iron II – 40%; Late Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 20%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 10%.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 56: 19-17/96/4
ARGAMAN (2)

Israel grid: 1996/1763

UTM grid: 7380/5633

Elevation: 180 m b.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
2.8 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
1.2 km distant

Visit: March 1989; 16 sherds

This is a small site in the eastern fringes of the Argaman valley, about 500 m north of Argaman. This is an inner valley, due to the widening of Wadi Umm Khubeza before it reaches Wadi Abu Sidreh. Above the site to the east is the hilltop upon which is the fortified Rom camp of Khirbet Khiraf (Zertal 2008: site 266). An unpaved road ascends from the site to the hilltop and then descends to the Jordan Valley. At the foot of the site is a shallow ravine which empties into Wadi Umm Khubeza.

In the place are very poor remains of several structures, with walls built of fieldstones. The walls are about 80 cm thick, but due to the massive destruction it is very difficult to understand the plan of the structures.

In the site are scattered small pottery fragments, and identifying periods is uncertain.

Pottery: Iron I-II – 100%.

Flint: 4 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.

Site 57: 19-17/95/1

ARGAMAN (3)

Israel grid: 1998/1759

UTM grid: 7382/5629

Elevation: 2●8 m b.s.l., 5● m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: caves and enclosures

Area: 1 dunam (1●●● sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
2.5 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B1●),
5●● m distant

Visits: Jan. 199●, May 2●●1; 48 sherds

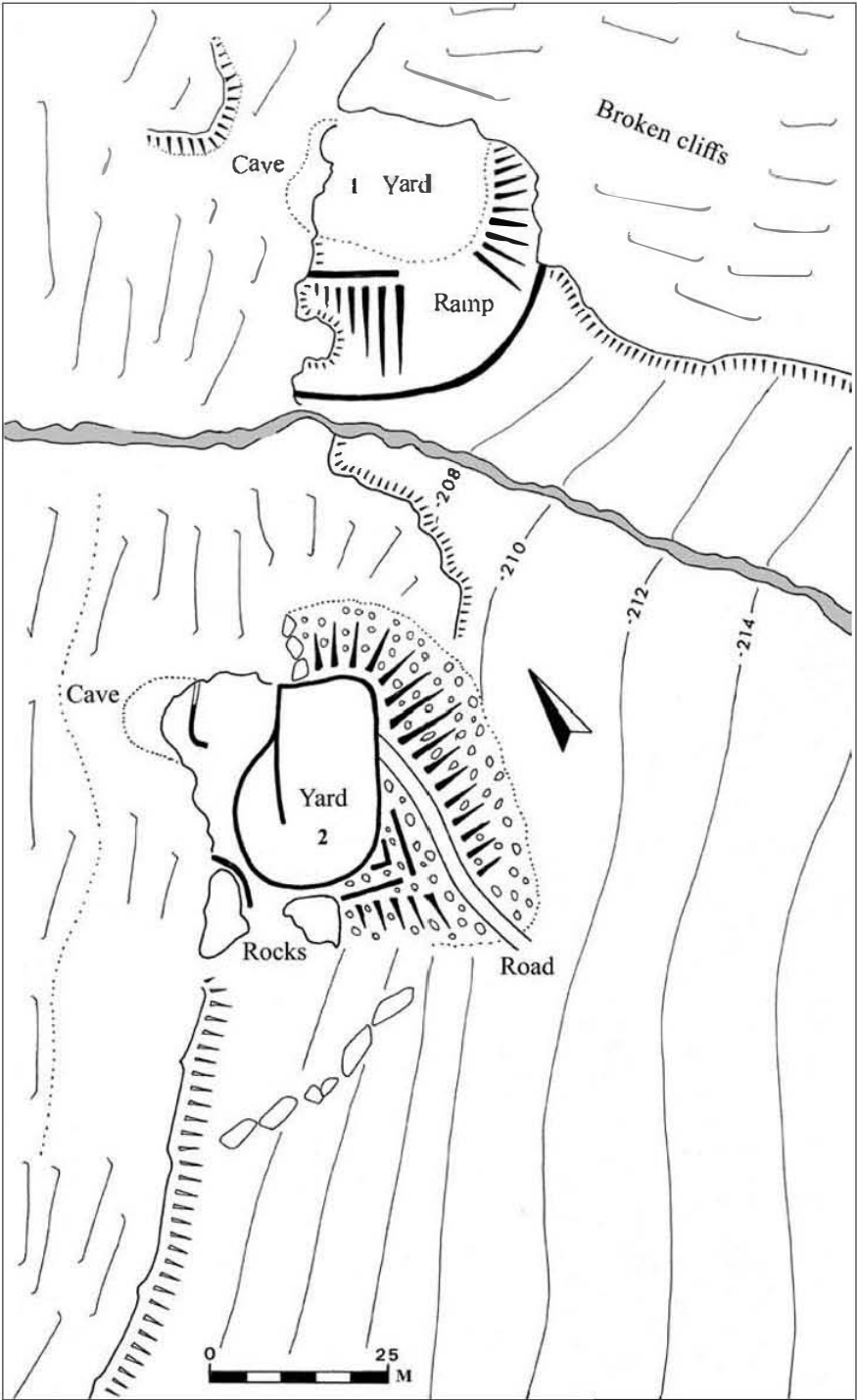
These are two caves and structures in front of them on a rocky slope descending to the east from the Argaman ridge to the Jordan Valley, about 5●● m north of Argaman. The old approach road ascends westward south of the site from the Jordan Valley road and crosses the village of Zbeidat.

In the site are two caves about 1●● m apart with a ravine between them:

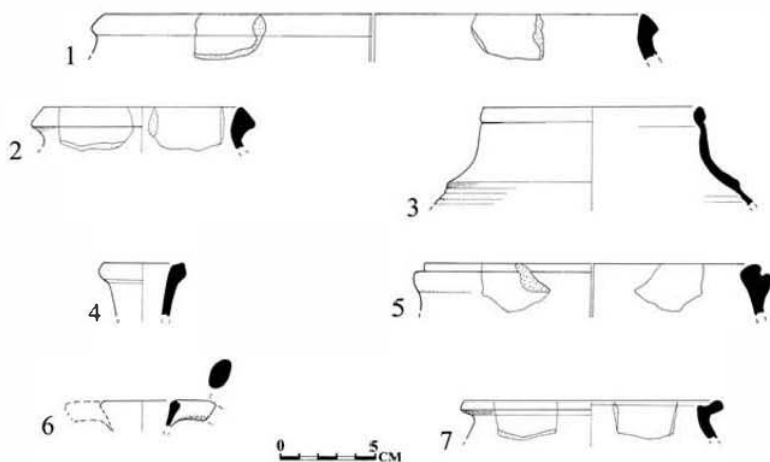
1. The northern cave is east and south of the fractured cliffs of the Khiraf ridge. In front of it is a levelled enclosure about 25 m in diameter, on a



117. Argaman (3), view to the south. The courtyards are marked by numbers, 2003 (M. Einav).



118. Plan of Argaman (3), 2001.



119. Pottery from Argaman (3): 1. Krater, lt brn, Ir II; 2. Jar, brn, Ir II; 3-4. Jar and jug, lt brn, LR; 5. CP, dk brn, Ir II; 6. Jug, lt brn, Ir II; 7. Bowl, cream, Rom.

semicircular dike built of whitish ground chalk 8 m above the valley. At its bottom is a curved wall which supported the dike. Many flint items were found in and around the enclosure.

2. In front of the southern cave is a larger enclosure (30×30 m), also levelled and encircled by a narrow wall. This enclosure is divided into two by an inner wall, and is supported by a curved dike rising 6 to 7 m above the slope. The dike is built of large stones, at its northern end reaching a fragmented cliff about 10 m high. In the centre of the stone dike a road about 3 m wide ascends diagonally to the enclosure.

In the cliffs above the valley are more rock-cut openings, serving currently (and in the past) for flock husbandry. In the dike area and down the slope are scattered many sherds.

The site differs from other sites of this type, having courtyards adjacent to the cliffs. Here is a much more massive construction, with a surface level with the cave entrance above the slope. There is also a good view to the area of the *Ghor*. This site was also possibly dated to the Palaeolithic, see Appendix A.

Pottery: Iron II - 50%; Late Roman - 50%.

Flint: 58 items, Upper Palaeolithic, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.

Site 58: 2●-17/●5/1

ARGAMAN (1)

Israel grid: 2●●3/1759

UTM grid: 7388/5629

Elevation: 24● m b.s.l., 1● m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: cave and enclosure

Area: 4.5 dunams (45●● sq. m)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: vegetables

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
2 km distantRoad: Beit She'an–Jericho (B1●),
next to the site

Visit: Jan. 199●; 4● sherds

This is a large and complex cave site within and next to a high cliff, located south and below the Roman camp at Khirbet Khiraf (Zertal 2●●8: site 266). The cliff, about 5● m high, joins the north Zbeidat Valley, which is below the hill of Argaman, and west of the Jordan Valley road.

The site has an inner small semicircular valley in the slope in the cliff north of the Zbeidat valley. Six or more caves originating in the cliff open into this valley. In front, down the slope, is a courtyard built of very large stones. The courtyard is 5●×4● m, and inside it are a smaller courtyard and other built divisions.



120. Argaman (1), view to the north-east, 1990. The site is in the caves inside the cliffs (A. Zertal).

In the courtyard are scattered sherds, and currently it serves as part of an irrigated vegetable garden. An iron irrigation water pipe passes through the centre.

Pottery: Late Roman – 80%; Early Moslem – 15%; unidentified – 5%.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 59: 19-17/84/3

WADI UMM KHARUBEH (1)

Israel grid: 1989/1748

UTM grid: 7373/5618

Elevation: 240 m b.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name: nearest place

Site type: courtyards and caves

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
3 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
500 m distant

Visits: March 1989, June 2000;

80 sherds

Courtyards and caves west of and close to Wadi Umm Kharubeh, which comes out from the Kharubeh ridge and descends to the Jordan Valley to the area of the greenhouses of Argaman. The site is on the west side of the curve of the road ascending to Argaman.

The site includes several caves in a low cliff about 3 m high. In front of the largest of them is a very large enclosure built of fieldstones, about 1 m higher than the surroundings, measuring 25×20 m. In front of one of the caves is a balcony-like ramp. Adjacent to the main courtyard, to the north, is a smaller cave, and next to it is another courtyard measuring 10×5 m.

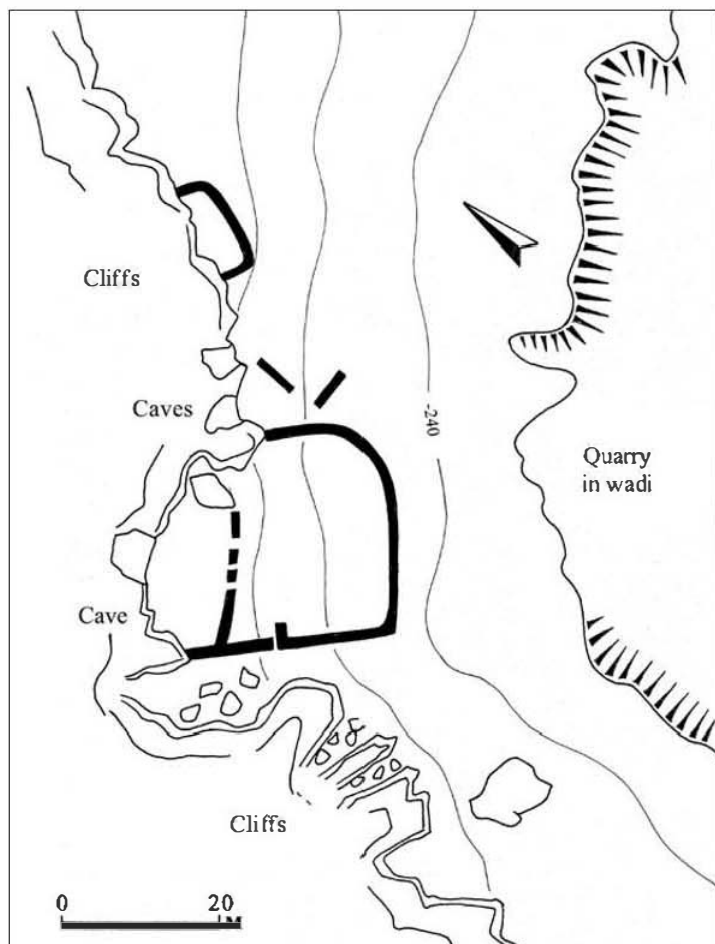
Over the entire area, opposite the caves and in the courtyards, are spread many sherds. Earlier period sherds were seen when descending to the Wadi Umm Kharubeh riverbed.

Pottery: Chalcolithic – 2%; Late Bronze – 2%; Iron II – 10%; Early and Late Roman – 30%; Byzantine – 56%.

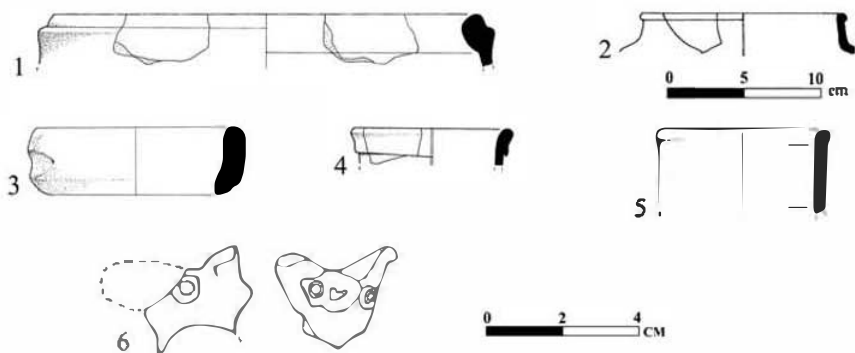
Flint: 13 items, see Appendix A.

Stone: 4 items, possibly Chalcolithic (see Eitam 2005: 689-691).

Additional surveys: none.



121. Plan of Wadi Umm Kharubeh (1), 2001.



122. Pottery from Wadi Umm Kharubeh (1): 1. CP, dk brn, Ir II; 2. Jar, cream, LR; 3. Base?, brn; 4-5. Jars, brn, ER; 6. Cypriot type, bull's head, import, gr, LB.

Site 60: 19-17/94/1

ZBEIDAT

Israel grid: 1995/1748	Soil quality: 2
UTM grid: 7379/5618	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 220 m b.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name: nearest place	Water source: River Jordan (112), 2.5 km distant
Site type: cave and courtyard	Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10), 500 m distant
Area: 12 dunams (1.2 ha)	Visit: May 2002; 89 sherds
Topography: slope	
Rock type: Avdat Group	
Soil type: stony-desert	

This is a large site on a south-facing slope, west and above the village of Zbeidat, and south of Argaman. The site is surrounded by cliffs, utilized by the site's inhabitants.

The site has several parts as follows:

1. Abu Zineh cave: The cave, situated in the upper northern part of the site, served for dwelling. The abundance of sherds and bones in the litter in front of its entrance is evidence. The cave is about 25 m deep, decreasing in width from 5 m at the opening to 2 m further inside. The ceiling is 2-3 m high. The cave entrance is blocked by a new wall. Over its floor is a thick layer of ash and various other deposits, evidence of prolonged habitation periods.
2. In the southern part of the site, next to a low upright rock, is an irregular courtyard, encircled by a stone wall, measuring 20×15 m.
3. A thick wall starts from a corner of the courtyard, crossing the slope eastward and meeting the cliff. The well-constructed wall is built of two rows of medium-sized stones and over it is an additional row of stones standing upright. From the wall going south are two parallel walls, about 1 m apart, perhaps a sort of alley.
4. South down the slope are two supporting walls built of large boulders, enclosing two narrow gullies between the cliffs. These walls apparently served as terraces, trapping the silt and being used for cultivation.

Up the slope and close to the cave are additional walls supporting cultivation terraces over the slope.

This site is one of series of sites in the Jordan Valley taking advantage of cliffs and caves for dwelling and livestock husbandry. It is a multi-period site, and

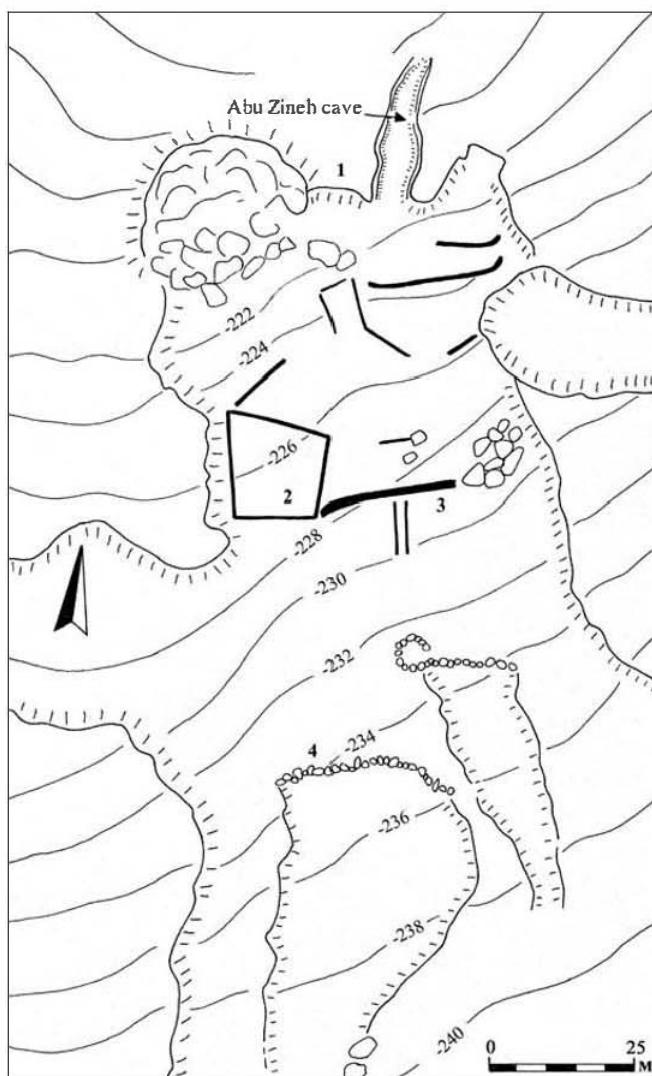
especially worth noting is the very rare Yarmukian Pottery Neolithic presence (see Bar and Rosenberg 2011).

Pottery: Neolithic – 10%; Chalcolithic – 8%; Early Bronze I-II – 6%; Middle Bronze II – 6%; Iron I – 3%; Iron II – 17%; Hellenistic – 2%; Early Roman – 17%; Late Roman – 11%; Byzantine – 7%; Middle Ages – 2%; Modern – 11%.

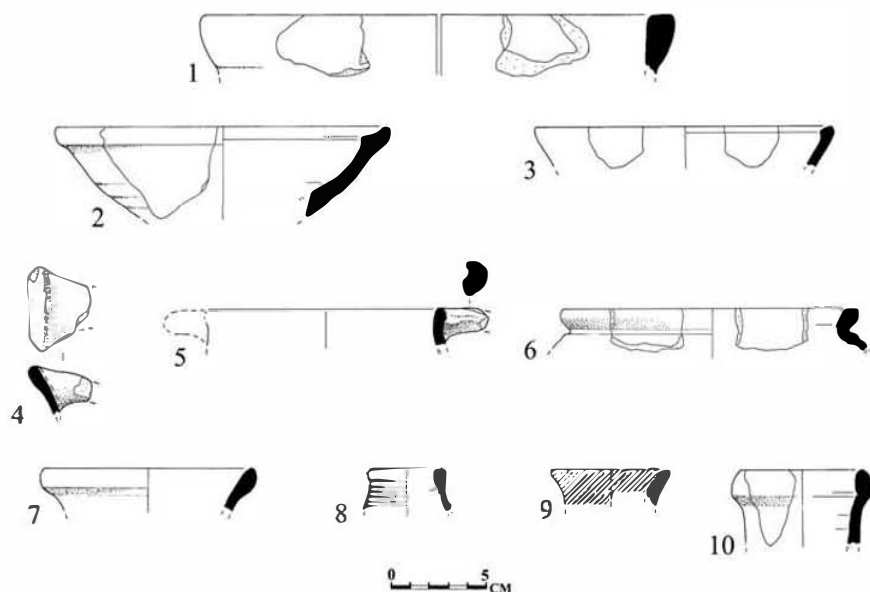
Flint: 17 items, see Appendix A.

Additional surveys: none.

Additional Bibliography: Bar 2014a: site 52.



123. Plan of Zbeidat site, 2002.



124. Pottery from Zbeidat: 1. Krater, gr, MA; 2. Bowl, rd, ER; 3. Bowl, lt brn, Ir II; 4. Jar handle, brn, Ir II; 5-6. Bowls, brn, Ir II; 7, 10. Jars, Hel-Er; 8. Juglet, brn, Hel; 9. Juglet, painted rd, Ir I-II.



Site 61: 19-17/85/1

WADI UMM KHARUBEH (2)

Israel grid: 1986/1751
 UTM grid: 737●/5621
 Elevation: 19● m b.s.l., 3● m b.s.a.
 Name: nearest place
 Site type: encampment
 Area: 2● dunams (2 ha)
 Topography: spurs
 Rock type: Tiberias Group
 Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 1
 Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: none
 Water source: River Jordan (112),
 3.5 km distant
 Road: Beit She'an-Jericho (B1●),
 1.3 km distant
 Visit: Dec. 5, 1989; 1●2 sherds

This is a cluster of sites spread over wide spurs descending from the south to Wadi Umm Kharubeh, in the Umm Kharubeh ridge area about 6●● m south-west of Argaman.

Over the spurs were observed remains of encampments of simple construction, with a few sherds scattered among them. The remains include circular

tent foundations made to secure the tent fly. In the corners are large stones. In addition there are various pits for installations and facilities.

The site is 10 to 20 m above the riverbed, and was constructed in order to prevent floods from harming the encampment. It seems that the place served as a tent encampment for a long period.

Pottery: Byzantine – 80%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 10%.

Additional surveys: none.



Site 62: 19-17/94/2

CAVE SITE (2)

Israel grid: 1996/1745

UTM grid: 7380/5616

Elevation: 260 m b.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name: given by the Survey team

Site type: caves

Area: 6 dunams (6000 sq. m)

Topography: valley margins

Rock type: Avdat Group

Soil type: stony-desert

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: River Jordan (112),
2.2 km distant

Road: Beit She'an–Jericho (B10),
300 m distant

Visit: Nov. 1989; 9 sherds

A site at the valley margins at the foot of the cliff, close to the road ascending from the Jordan Valley road to Argaman. Nearby to the east are the vegetable gardens of Zbeidat.

In the cliff were found openings of three caves, apparently used for dwelling. They vary between 10 and 20 m deep, and the entrances are 3–4 m wide. All the ceilings are charred, and over the floors is a fairly deep layer of litter and refuse. Their use for dwelling and flock husbandry lasted until modern times.

Pottery: Iron I – 70%; modern – 30%.

Additional surveys: none.